



PARISH

of Aghagallon & Ballinderry

There will be a second collection this weekend for the Monthly Stipend

The annual stipend to be paid is now £23,040.00 and applies to all priests in ministry equally. This will meet Home Office requirement on 'sponsoring international workers' i.e.

international priests ministering in the Diocese. To ensure we continue to cover a resident priest our monthly stipend needs to be £1,920.00 per month before tax.

Growing In Faith Together Programme Monday 14th Sep 2026 in Aghagallon Community Centre from 7.30pm-9pm for Year 8's. Applications forms have been sent out, if you did not receive one come along with an adult on the first evening to complete an application form.

Children's Liturgy If you wish to present your son/daughter for any sacraments this year then they must attend Mass on a regular basis. **What does a regular basis mean?** Catholics are obliged to attend Mass once a week, a Saturday Evening Vigil or Sunday, and on Holy Days of Obligation. All of your family are very welcome at any Mass, don't worry about little ones making noise, they are just saying their prayers in their own way. Children's Liturgy will begin on Sunday 13th September 2026 at 11am Mass.

New School Year Mass The pupils and staff from St Mary's and St Patrick's Primary School's will join us for Mass on Wednesday 16th September 2026 at 10am. Everyone Welcome.

Dear Lord Jesus, watch over our children as they begin this new school year. Keep them safe, happy, and strong. Guide their hearts and minds, help them to be kind and respectful, and give them courage when things are difficult.

Bless their teachers, friends, and families, and help them grow in wisdom, faith, and love.

Amen.

WEEKLY BULLETIN

Sunday 6th September 2026

Weekly Collection
£1,175.00
Online
£94.83
Total: £1,269.83

Thank you for your continued support

The Sanctuary Lamp will burn this week for a Special Intention

Weekly Mass Schedule

7th Sep – 13th Sep 2026

Mass

Monday: 10.00am
Tuesday: 7.00pm
Wednesday: 10.00am
Thursday: 10.00am
Saturday: 7.00pm
(Vigil)
Sunday: 9am & 11am

Adoration

Wednesday 10am-6pm

Liturgy of the Word

Friday: 10am

MINISTRY OF WELCOME

We welcome Baby Daisy

who was baptised recently into our Parish family

Booking Masses, Baptisms and Weddings As parish office opening hours have been reduced slightly, we are returning to our previous practice of booking Masses, baptisms and weddings in person, in the sacristy after Masses.

Masses can be booked well in advance to ensure your preferred dates are available.
Baptisms can only be booked by the child's parent or legal guardian. At least one month's notice is required. To book a baptism parents must present the child's long birth certificate, complete the baptism request form, meet with one of our Baptism team and attend weekly Mass during the month prior to the date of the Baptism

Weddings can be booked by the couple themselves. Couples are required to give at least six months' notice of marriage to ensure the preferred date is available and that there is adequate time to complete all Civil and Church paperwork.

RECENTLY DECEASED

Brian McGarry

Tom Dowdall

Mary Orr

Iris Craig

Michelle Latimer (nee Rush) Month's Mind Mass Sunday 13th September at 9am

ANNIVERSARIES AT THIS TIME

Sean Toomey

Deceased members of the McKay Family

Deceased members of the Campbell Family

Patrick McCrystal

Colin Toomey

Pat Lavery

Barry Geraghty

Seamus Nelson

Robert McVeigh (Sen)

Dolores Cushley

Lottie Lavery

Seamus Loughran (8)

Sean McKavanagh

Jim McGarrell (37)

Stephen McGarrell(9)

Brigid Skelton (22)

Anniv Mass Sat 5th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sun 6th Sep at 9am

Anniv Mass Sun 6th Sep at 11am

Anniv Mass Tue 8th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sat 12th Sep at 7pm

Anniv Mass Sun 13th Sep at 11am

Anniv Mass Tue 15th Sep at 7pm

Aghagallon Community Centre Mother and Toddler group resumes on Friday 11th September 2026, 10am-11.30am

Parish Office Tel: 02892 651214

Email: parishofaandb@yahoo.co.uk

Parish Office Open Tue, Wed & Fri 11am-3pm

All insertions for the bulletin – please leave in the Parochial house red post box, email or phone the parish office before 4pm on Tuesday.

Parish Priest: Fr Declan Mulligan

02892651214

Parish Office Mobile:

Catherine 07485605252

EMERGENCIES AND SICK CALLS

07831 934 756

(in the event you are unable to reach Fr Declan on the emergency number)

02894 422278

St Vincent De Paul

Contact Number:

07598 076585

www.svp.ie

Lifeline Freephone 0808 808 8000

The Knights of St Columbanus

028 92 528 916

Diocesan Safeguarding Office

028 9049 2798



Parish Bulletin

for
Ramoan

(Ballycastle, Glenshesk & Rathlin)
and

Ballintoy & Ballinlea
(Mass Readings: Sunday Cycle A)

Parish Emergency Mobile: 07809553349.
www.ballycastleparish.com

Parish Office, Mon-Fri 9am-2pm: 20762223
ballycastle@downandconnor.org

Mass and Confessions Schedule in Ballycastle

Vigil Mass on Saturday at 6.30pm, and Masses on Sunday at 10am and 12noon.
Daily Mass: 10am, with Sacrament of Reconciliation after Saturday 10am Mass

Upcoming Mass Schedule

Ballintoy: Sat 5th Sept at 5.30pm Glenshesk: Sun 13th Sept at 9am. Ballinlea: Sun 20th Sept at 9am.

Youth Choir

🎵 Every other Saturday starting Saturday 5th Sept with 5.15pm rehearsal for 6.30pm Mass.
New members welcome. Age: P4 upwards
Contact Noilin 07852263060

Lough Derg

One Day Retreats

of guided prayer and reflection are available on September 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th & 20th
Further information at www.loughderg.org or info@loughderg.org



The Causeway Coast Peace Group

meet on Tuesday, 8th September, 10am-12noon (Tea / Coffee 10-10.30am)
in Ballintoy Parish Church Hall with speaker Shona McCarthy
on the theme "Peace Through a Creative Lens".
New members / attendees always welcome

We extend a warm welcome

The Rev Emma Gibson

**who was formally instituted as rector of the Church of Ireland
Parishes of Ramoan and Culfeightrin on Friday 4th September.**

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage

to Knock Shrine will take place on Sun 27 Sept.
A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm.
Information / booking: 07510547636 (Legion of Mary)

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.
The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).
and will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.
All men are very welcome.
For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Temporary Building Supervisor required at St Olcan's Primary School, Armoy for 18.5 hrs per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended; experience preferred.

Please send your CV to mkennedy502@c2kni.net if you would be interested in this post.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament

every Monday, immediately after 10am Mass until 1.30pm. All welcome

We pray for our deceased parishioners, relatives and friends, especially those who died recently

Seamus Walsh (Leyland Farm),
Dermot Hurley (Castle Street; originally Maghera),
Michael McConville (Belfast & formerly Ballycastle) and
Patrick McGothigan (Germany; originally Magherahoney)

and those whose anniversaries occur at this time

Robbie Elliot (1st), Kieran Grant (1st), Joseph McAuley, Maureen & James Forrester, Francie Black,
John McLaughlin, Annie McCaughan, Mary Ann Bakewell, Jimmy Gibson, Mary Girvan,
Patrick & Maureen Hetherington, Andrew McLernon and Francie McGinty

Requiescant in Pace

We welcome
*to the worshipping community of the parishes of
Ramoan, Ballycastle and of Ballintoy*

Aran Taylor
Ben Taylor
Eiblinn McCaughan
Jack Tolan
Leo McLean
Arlo Whelan-Neill
Naoise Whelan-Neill
Grace Connolly
Orlaith Connolly
Rian Soave
Blanaid McCaughan
Oisin McAlonan
Kaleb Farrelly
Brianna McAfee

who were baptised over the last two months.



Baptism is the gateway to life in the Spirit and the door which gives access to the other sacraments. Through Baptism we are freed from sin and reborn as children of God; and become members of Christ.

Apostolic Work collection totalled £1,008.20. Thank you to all who contributed and special thanks to SVdP, and to Bridie O'Neill and Riona for helping out on the day.



The Foodbank is very much in need of tinned veg (e.g. peas and carrots), tinned meats (e.g. tuna, corned beef and ham), packets of biscuits (e.g. digestives and kitkats), tinned rice and custard.



Al Anon

If you are concerned about a loved ones drinking, you are not alone.
Ballycastle Al Anon family group meet every Monday in 62 Ann St, from 6 to 7pm.

Please note change of venue, day and time.

Newcomers are very welcome

Confidential helplines: 08000086811 and 028-90682368.

Email: helpline@al-anonuk.org.uk

Day trip to Knock

Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am.

Contact Patricia Campbell on 028-27641120 or 07871626940. Price approx £30 depending on numbers.

Useful numbers

Saint Vincent de Paul 07754722022.

Bethany Bereavement Support 07519471481.

Foodbank 07536986448.

BabyBank 07801630476 or 07929785256.

Legion of Mary 07510547636.



The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

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Notice Board

The Parish of Ballyclare & Ballygowan

6 September 2026

(028) 9334 2226 ballyclare@downandconnor.org

 @ballyclareballygowanparish

The Faithful Departed

Recently Deceased: Monica Harris

Anniversaries: Teddy McCudden, Eileen Foley, Elizabeth McGookin, John Flynn, John Joseph Ryan, Thomas McFall, Kathleen McToal, Seamus McAlinden, Pauline Rogan, James Joseph McAlinden, Margaret Quinn

Eternal Rest Grant unto them, O Lord, and let perpetual light shine upon them.

Masses this week: No weekday Mass this week

Offerings: Thank you for your recent offerings.

30 August – Weekly Offering £379.50

Holy Family Church will reopen on Sunday 4th October with a celebratory Mass at 3.00pm. All welcome, refreshments afterwards.

A Special Mass to mark the opening of the Season of Creation will be held this evening, Sunday 6 September at 6.00pm in St Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. This year, under the theme "Living Water" we are again called to renew and deepen our commitment to care for our common home through prayer and action. Celebrant Fr Piaras Jackson SJ

Catholic Men's Retreat: Standing in the Breach: Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Called & Gifted - Discover Your Spiritual Gifts Have you ever wondered how God might be working in your life, or what gifts He has given you to use for others? Called and Gifted is a guided process to help you discern the Spiritual gifts you received at your Baptism, and how God is calling you to use them. We invite you to journey with others to discover: Who God is calling you to be; How the Holy Spirit is at work in your life; The unique gifts you have been given to share with others. This engaging programme will run for two Saturdays and three Wednesday evenings in Belfast. For more information and details of how to register please contact the Pathways to the Future team pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org (028) 9069 0920

Belfast Jesuit Centre: Two new programmes starting this September: A Year of Ignatian Prayer and The Chosen Season 2 - weekly screenings. For more information please visit the centre website belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk or email bjc@jesuit.ie

Thinking about becoming Catholic, or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults wishing to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026-2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30 pm to 8.00pm in St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés, and friends are also very welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after time away. To find out more, scan the QR code to visit our information page, or email rcia@downandconnor.org to register.



<i>This Week's Hymns</i>			
Entrance	395	Communion	260
Offertory	687	Recessional	442



Please click on the button if you wish to make an online donatation to the Parish of Ballyclare and Ballygowan. Thank you.





Parish of Ballymoney
& Derrykeighan
CAUSEWAY FAMILY OF PARISHES

6th September 2026
Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time



HOW TO DEAL WITH COMPLAINTS

This Sunday's readings tackle a subject we all find awkward: how to give and receive criticism. In the first reading, Ezekiel is called by God to speak out against sin, even though he cannot guarantee people will listen. In the Gospel, Jesus gives practical advice for confronting someone who has wronged us — first privately, then with a friend, always seeking reconciliation rather than revenge.

The lesson is one of patient love. We shouldn't gossip or hold grudges, but speak honestly and calmly, wanting the relationship restored rather than "winning." Sometimes the wisest course is to wait until we can speak without anger. And when we ourselves feel let down, even by God, we're free to bring him our complaints too — he can bear them.

THIS WEEK

Parish webcam can be viewed on our YouTube channel
(search for Ballymoney Parish)

SUNDAY 6th	9.30am Mass
MONDAY 7th	10am Mass
WEDNESDAY 9th	10am Mass 7pm Rosary
FRIDAY 11th	6pm Adoration & Confessions 7pm Mass
SATURDAY 12th	5.30-5.50pm Confessions 6pm Mass

Our Lady & St Patrick's church is open every day
for private prayer - usually from 10am to 7pm.

Other Sunday Masses in the Causeway Family of Parishes

Saturday 4.30pm	-	Portstewart
Sunday 10am	-	Portstewart
Sunday 11.30am	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine
Sunday 12noon	-	Portrush
Sunday 5pm	-	St Malachy's, Coleraine

WE PRAY FOR THE FAITHFUL DEPARTED

Month's Mind

Frankie McEldowney

Anniversaries

Danny Coyles, Michael Coyles, James Douglas,
John & Florence Kirgan, Florena Moore

REQUIESCAT IN PACE

PARISH FINANCES

Thank you to everyone who supports the parish through our collections. If you want to request a box of envelopes there is a purple form at the back of the church. Remember that you can also support the parish through a regular standing order or by making a one off payment through your bank or online. Our account details are:

Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan
Sort code: 95-06-79
Account No: 10020192.

If you want to give by cheque please make payable to:
Parish of Ballymoney & Derrykeighan.

SEASON OF CREATION

The Church's Season of Creation runs throughout September and on until the feast of St Francis of Assisi on October 4th.

Bishop Alan McGuckian writes "I warmly encourage our parishes, schools, families and communities throughout the diocese to participate in the Season of Creation. May we be inspired to take practical steps, however small, to care for God's creation and to work for environmental justice.

"May this Season of Creation deepen our gratitude for the gift of creation, strengthen our commitment to environmental justice, and inspire us to become faithful stewards of the earth entrusted to our care."

BLESSING OF PETS

Once again we will be marking the Season of Creation with a blessing of animals inspired by the ministry of St Francis of Assisi. Our pets and animals remind us of the beauty and diversity God has given us in the natural world. This year the blessing service takes place here in Ballymoney in the grounds of the church on **Sunday 27th September** at **2pm**. All welcome to attend and bring along your animals to be blessed.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL

Our parish SVP conference is here to support our local community, and we do this in the strictest confidence. If you are in need and would like our help please do not hesitate to get in touch on **07860 455 549**.



SVP ANNUAL OUTING

The Society of St Vincent de Paul, Ballymoney, are hosting their annual outing for senior citizens and those living alone on **Sunday 20th September**.

This year's event will offer a shopping trip followed by an evening meal. Transport is being organised for those wishing to attend with number limited to 48. Anyone with mobility issues please speak to a member of SVP prior to the event. A donation of £5 per person would be greatly appreciated.

Anyone interested in attending should call the SVP number (**07860 455 549**) and leave their name and contact number, or speak to an SVP representative.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

A new committee to promote Eucharistic Adoration in our diocese is being set up. They are looking for people who would be interested in supporting their work through promotion, speaking in parishes, organisation or prayer. If you're interested in getting involved please speak to Fr Damian for more information.

CAUSEWAY COAST PEACE GROUP

The group invite you to the first in their 25th Anniversary series of meetings for 2026-27 on **Tuesday 8th September** at **10am** in **Ballintoy Parish Church Hall**. The speaker will be Shona McCarthy who is speaking on *Peace Through a Creative Lens*. A warm welcome will be extended to all who come along.

PARISH OF BALLYMONEY
& DERRYKEIGHAN

Diocese of Down & Connor
Causeway Family of Parishes

Contact Details

Very Rev. Damian McCaughan PP VF

81 Castle Street
BALLYMONEY
Co. Antrim
BT53 6JT

Tel: 028 2766 2003
Email: ballymoney@downandconnor.org

Website: www.ballymoneyparish.com
Facebook: [@ballymoneycatholic](https://www.facebook.com/ballymoneycatholic)

HYMNS FOR MASS

Soul of my Saviour sanctify my breast,
Body of Christ, be thou my saving guest,
Blood of my Saviour, bathe me in thy tide,
wash me with water flowing from thy side.

Strength and protection may thy passion be,
O blessed Jesus, hear and answer me;
deep in thy wounds, Lord, hide and shelter me,
so shall I never, never part from thee.

O Lord, my God,
when I, in awesome wonder
Consider all
the worlds Thy hands have made
I see the stars,
I hear the rolling thunder
Thy power throughout
the universe displayed

Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.
Then sings my soul,
my Saviour God to Thee,
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.

OLD & NEW@No.5

There's lots of new stock again this week from an old vintage sewing machine to a large pair of two handled vases, nice pairs of candlesticks, jug and basin sets, and much more.

Visit us at 5 Gate End, Ballymoney, open **Wednesday to Saturday, 10am - 4.30pm**. To keep in touch with our offers and to see pictures of our stock don't forget our Facebook page **@oldandnewatno5**

MEN'S RETREAT

A Catholic men's retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19th September**, from **9am** to **1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on **07967 620435** or email **sean@catholicminute.co.uk**

CAUSEWAY PARISHES PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK

There will be a pilgrimage to Knock Shrine for our Causeway Family of Parishes on **Saturday 3rd October** led by **Fr Kevin McGuckien**. The bus will make pickups from Portrush, Portstewart, Coleraine and Ballymoney leaving at approximately 7am and returning around 10.30pm. The cost is **£35 for adults** and **£10 for children**. You can book a place by phoning **07724 092063**.

OTHER TRIPS TO KNOCK

The Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine will take place on **Sunday 27th September**. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: **07471537051**

There will be another trip to Knock on **Saturday 3rd October**. A bus will be leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on **02827641120** or **07871626940**.

PARISH OF BANGOR, MEMBER OF ARDS FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish Priest: Very Rev Joseph Gunn St Comgall's Presbytery, 27 Brunswick Road, Bangor, Co Down, BT20 3DS
T: (028) 9146-5522 **Permanent Deacon:** Rev James McAllister **T:** 07751 851444
Email: bangor@downandconnor.org **Website:** www.bangorparish.com **Office Hours:** Mon-Fri 10am to 1pm.

Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time, Year A – 6th September 2026

Your prayers are requested for:

Recently Deceased:

Desmond Donaghy
 Frank Boyd (Downpatrick)

Anniversaries:

Una Ferguson
 Loretta Brennan
 Patrick & Caroline Duffy
 Roseleen Gibson
 Harry Shields
 Emmanuel Shields
 John Finlay
 Angela Coan

MASS TIMES NEXT WEEK**DAILY MASS:**

Monday 7th – Friday 11th September @ 9.30am

ST. COMGALL'S CHURCH DONAGHADEE

Sunday 13th September 2026 @ 9am

ST COMGALL'S CHURCH BRUNSWICK ROAD

Saturday 12th September @ 6.30pm

Sunday 13th September @ 10am & 12noon

BAPTISMS

Please register online SIDE BAR under Baptism registration
Baptisms are celebrated on Sundays @ 1.15pm



TRÔCAIRE COFFEE MORNING

In aid of disaster in Nepal

Sunday 20 September in Parish
Centre

Tea/coffee & traybakes
 Big ballot
 Tombola

Please support our appeal



ST COLUMBANUS' COLLEGE

TRADITIONAL MUSIC & Coffee Morning FUNDRAISER

JOIN US FOR GREAT MUSIC,
GOOD COMPANY & FRESH COFFEE

SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER
AFTER 12.00 MASS
ST COMGALL'S PARISH CENTRE

All proceeds will go towards a
**SPORTS TRIP
TO
NYC
IN OCTOBER**

NEW YORK
NEW YORK

♡ Thank you for your support! ♡

PARISH CENTRE – PARISH GROUPS 2025

MONDAYS	TUESDAYS	WEDNESDAYS	THURSDAYS	FRIDAYS
BRIDGE CLUB at 7.15pm until 9.45pm [Minor Hall] LECTIO DIVINA GROUP 7.30pm – 8.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] BADMINTON NOW WEEKLY at 8 to 9pm [Main Hall]	FRIENDSHIP CLUB at 10.30am [Minor Hall] IRISH DANCING CLASSES at 6.00pm to 8.30pm [Main Hall] SVP at 7.30pm to 9.30pm [St Dymphna's Room]	MEDITATION GROUP at 12pm to 1.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] FOLK GROUP AT 6.30 -7.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] SENIOR CHOIR At 7.30pm [St Dymphna's Room] YOUTH CLUB AT 6.30 -8.30pm [Main Hall]	St Comgall's Guide Unit (Girls aged 6-18) at 6.15pm to 8pm [Main/Minor Hall] IRISH LANGUAGE CLASS At 7pm to 8pm [St Dymphna's Room] CEILI DANCING at 8.15pm to 9.30pm [Minor Hall]	Ju-Jitsu Club (Juniors 5-15yrs) 6-7pm [Main Hall] Discussion Group At 7.30pm – 9pm [St. Dymphna's Room]

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation

6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast
 Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (*Is* 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor.

We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Children's Liturgy

Children's Liturgy will be starting on the 27th September. New forms have to be filled in. Lisa will have them at back of church before and after mass this week.

Parishioners are kindly requested to submit notices for the newsletter and anniversary mass requests to the parish office by Wednesday of each week (Mon to Fri 10am – 1pm) or via bangor@downandconnor.org

ST VINCENT DE PAUL HELPLINES

Bangor Conference 07703679384
 (covering Bangor West, Clandeboye/Newtownards Road area, Kilcooley, Helens Bay and Crawfordsburn)
Ballyholme/Donaghadee Conference 07703679389. (covering Bangor city centre, Bangor East/Ballyholme, Balloo/Bloomfield Road area, Groomsport, Donaghadee and Millisle)

Parish of Bright Bulletin

Twenty-Third Sunday Ordinary Time - 6th September 2026

Parish Priest: Fr Peter O'Kane,
16 Rossglass Road, Killough, BT30 7QN
Tel: 028 4484 1221
Email: parishofbright@downandconnor.org
Website: parishofbright.net

Mass Times: Week Beginning Monday 7th September

<u>St Patrick's, Legamaddy</u>	<u>St Joseph's, Killough</u>
7th September Monday 10am	8th September Tuesday 10am
11th September Friday 7.30pm	9th September Wednesday 7.30pm
13th September Sunday 10am.	12th September Saturday 10am
	12th September Saturday Vigil 6.30pm

Our Lady, Star of the Sea, Rossglass

10th September Thursday 10.00am

Faithful Departed

Recently Deceased: John Lundy (Saul & Ballee)

Month's Mind: Richard Smyth, Jeannine Schollhammer (Jersey)

Anniversaries: Tommy Connolly

Weekly Confessions

Sacrament of Reconciliation: after all weekday Masses; and in St Joseph's every Wednesday 8.00pm-8.45pm and at 6.00pm before the Saturday Vigil Mass.

Eucharistic Adoration

St Joseph's, Killough every Wed: 3.30pm -7.30pm & after Mass 8pm-9pm. St Patrick's, Legamaddy every Friday: 6.30pm-7.30pm.

Sunday Collections 30th August

Weekly £794-92. Thank you for your generous contributions.

Mass for the Sick and Infirm

The annual 'Mass for the Sick and the Infirm' will take place in Bright Community Hall, Ballynoe, BT30 8AJ at 12noon on Saturday 12th September. Neighbouring parishes are also very welcome to attend. Refreshments will be served afterwards. If you need transport please contact St Vincent de Paul: Nickey 07745 004510 or Sean 07548 647301.

Parish of Bright Cemetery Sunday 2027

Sunday 13th June: St Joseph's, Killough 1pm & Star of the Sea, Rossglass 3pm
Sunday 27th June: St Patrick's, Legamaddy 3pm.

Celebration of the Sacraments for our Primary Schools 2027

First Confession

St Patrick's PS: Monday 8th March in St Patrick's Church at 1.00pm

St Joseph's PS: Monday 15th March in St Joseph's Church at 1.00pm

Confirmation

St Patrick's & St Joseph's PSs: Thursday 22nd April, St Patrick's Church, Legamaddy at 11.00am with Bishop Alan McGuckian SJ

First Holy Communion

St Joseph's PS: Saturday 15th May in St Joseph's Church at 11.00am

St Patrick's PS: Saturday 22nd May in St Patrick's Church at 11.00am

Parish Pastoral Council 1st September 2026

During the meeting we discussed the following: The newly merged Parishes of Downpatrick and Bright Baptism Preparation Team is now providing courses for parents requesting Baptism in our parish, plans are progressing to provide Children's Liturgy at St Patrick's in Legamaddy (hopefully from October) and to involve the Primary 4 Come Follow Me group from St Joseph's in the Saturday Vigil Mass. Children's Liturgy will be provided by a number of catechists on the Come Follow Me Programme all of whom have undergone the appropriate level of safeguarding checks and training. We discussed how to most sensitively implement a new Diocesan process for parishioners who wish to avail of the Bereavement Ministry that recognises that not everyone will wish to do so.

The Pastoral Council plan to introduce 'Lectio Divina' as a way of enhancing the prayerfulness of our meetings, Father Peter will lead us in the reading, meditation, prayer and contemplation of the Gospel, based on resources accessed from the Dominican Lectio Divina Centre in Newry.

Proposed dates were suggested for the Mass for the Bereaved and the Inter-Church Carol Service (it is our turn to host this year) and are awaiting confirmation. Two dates that have been agreed include next year's Cemetery Sunday and Confirmation for children from both primary schools that will be held at St Patrick's - these dates will be published in the bulletin in due course. We all agreed that 'Ice Cream Sundays' had been a great success and these will be scheduled for next summer.

The next meeting of the Parish Pastoral Council will take place on Monday 5th October 2026.

The members of the Parish of Bright Pastoral Council are: Gertie Small (Chair), Suzanne Hogg (Secretary), Mary McGrath, Mary Wylie, Cyril Carr, Gerarde Dawe, Fr Peter.

Parish of Carrickfergus & Whitehead

Follow us on-line at
www.carrickparish.org

Saint Nicholas'

Our Lady of Lourdes

6th Sept 2026

23rd Sunday of the Year

Cycle A Week 3

Fr. Joe Davis

Tel: **028 9336 3269**

Parochial House,
8 Minorca Place,
Mount St. Nicholas, Carrickfergus,
Co. Antrim, BT38 8AU

Parish Email:

carrickfergus@downandconnor.orgWebsite: www.carrickparish.org**Office Hours**

Mon to Wed 1pm to 4.30pm

Requiescant in Pace**Recently Deceased**

Jaxon (Jax) Cummings
Winifred Cahill
John Weatherhead

Anniversaries

Sean Callaghan
Seamus Stewart

*Eternal rest grant unto them,
O Lord, and let perpetual light shine
upon them. May they rest in peace.
Amen*

PARISH RETREAT

Saturday 3rd October 5pm to
Sunday 5pm 2026.
To book your place please
phone Ruth Bates
on 0787 64208 67.

**The second collection today
is for the
Monthly Stipend.**

Children's Liturgy

resumes today Sunday 6th Sept.

Baptisms

(one month's notice)

Whitehead - 1st Sun of the month

C'fergus - 2nd Sun of the month

By arrangement with the Parish Office

Weddings

(three month's notice)

By arrangement

Funerals

By arrangement

Mass Times & Confessions this coming week

(** Streamed Mass - see parish website for link)

Weekday**Or Lady of Lourdes Whitehead**

Mon 7.00pm (with confessions 6.15pm to 6.50pm)

St. Nicholas Carrickfergus

Tues 10am

St. Nicholas Carrickfergus

Wed 10am (Funeral for John Weatherhead)

St. Nicholas Carrickfergus

Thurs 7.00pm (with confessions 6.15pm to 6.50pm)

St. Nicholas Carrickfergus

Fri 10am (Funeral for Winifred Cahill)

Weekend**Or Lady of Lourdes Whitehead**

Sun 9.30am (with confessions 9.00am to 9.20am)

St. Nicholas Carrickfergus

** Sun 11.30am (with confessions 11.00 am to 11.20am)

Holy Days : As announced.

Eucharistic Adoration

Our Lady of Lourdes Monday evening 6.15pm - 6.50pm.
St. Nicholas' Church Thursday evening 6.15pm - 6.50pm.
St. Nicholas' Church Saturday morning 11.00am - 12.00 noon.

Books from Fr Peter

Fr Peter has kindly left a selection of books for Parishioners to take.

It has been suggested that this is a good opportunity to raise some money for a worthy cause. To this end we would invite Parishioners to make a donation of perhaps 50p per book (or whatever they can afford) and all proceeds will be going towards the Northern Ireland Hospice and Children's Hospice.

The books have been set out on tables in the **Gathering space in St Nicholas'**
for after mass today Sun 6th and next Sun 13th Sept.

Thank you.

Sacramental Preparation

If you have a child in P3, P4 or P7 who is not attending St. Nicholas' Primary School or Acorn Integrated Primary School and you wish your child to be prepared for First Confession, First Communion or Confirmation please contact the Parish Office or Mary Muir (07971003405).

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Mon 14th Sept at 7.30pm in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age their child died or the circumstances of their death. You do not need to register in advance. We also offer an online support group meeting.

To find out more call **028 95213120** or email info@anamcara.ie www.anamcarani.co.uk

Beginning Experience

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating.

Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. Contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com



Parish Shop

The Parish Shop has now reopened after recent changes. Please feel free to call in.

Cards & Gifts

available from the Church Shop
Open each Sunday.

See parish website for more information

www.carrickparish.org/shop

Angel Gifts. Baptismal & Wedding, etc.



Opening Mass for the Season of Creation

6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme “Living Water”. 1st September was the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, “*The prophetic call to “beat swords into ploughshares” (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God’s grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue.*”

A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 – Belfast Jesuit Centre

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 Sept 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is “It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me” (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

This Coming Week 7th Sep – 13th Sep

Tues

Birthday of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wed

St. Ciaran

Fri

St. Deiniol

Sat

The Holy Name of Mary
St. Ailbe

Sun

Twenty Fourth Sunday of the year

Readings for Sun 13th Sep

Sirach 27: 30-28:7
Romans: 14:7-9

Contact details for the ‘Stella Maris’ Family of Parishes

Parish	Website	Priests	Telephone No.
Carrickfergus	www.carrickparish.org	Rev Joe Davis Adm	(028) 9336 3269
Glengormley	www.stmarysonthehill.online	Very Rev. Pat Sheehan PP Very Rev. Canon Aidan Kerr PE PM	(028) 9083 2979 (028) 9083 2488
Loughshore	www.loughshoreparishes.org	Very Rev. David Delargy PP	(028) 9037 0845

ST PATRICK'S AND ST BRIGID'S GLENARIFFE



TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY OF ORDINARY TIME



6th September 2026

“O that today you would listen to his voice, harden not your hearts”

WEEKDAY MASSES: Wednesday & Friday 7.30pm

WEEKEND MASSES: Saturday Vigil 7pm, Sunday 10am

THE MEDICAL MISSIONARIES OF MARY many thanks to all who have given your support to the above charity.

Please take a voting card; ASSIST US TO LIVE - NOT TO DIE. This vote takes place on 11th September, so complete and forward this week.

DECEASED: Jean McDonnell, Glenravel, (Bernie Haughey's mother)

MONTH'S MIND: Pat McNaughton, Tully

ANNIVERSARIES: Michael Graham, Patrick McAllister, Mary Murray, Seamus Waide, Martin McGinty, Sister Marie Grignon Hayes. Archie McIntosh, Cassie & Cahal McNaughton, Martin O'Boyle, John Collins, Jim Haughey, Greta McAllister

Thought for today:

Creation is God's work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures – indeed the whole cosmos – have beauty, dignity, and meaning before human presence. So, to be amazed at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up to the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the sea's edge. Everything belongs; every thing has beauty! The garden is such a model for our care of creation.

Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhyme of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find a home and a shelter in the garden.

Fr Donal Neary, S.J

Gospel Reflections for the Year of Matthew

www.messenger.ie/bookshop/

Each Other's Keepers

In any group, small and big, things cause friction. Everyone thinks his or her way is right. We can fight over who is right. Some things are worth a fight, others not.

In the big questions of life, we need the advice, support and love of the other. Many people ask themselves, "*Why I didn't give an honest opinion about a decision like marriage or a job or a course of studies which seemed ill-advised to everyone?*" We all have good and not-so-good tendencies. We can only advise as best we can, sensitively and wisely, and hope we get a hearing.

We are afraid to hurt, to be rejected. Why do we let so many people drink themselves into trouble and never tell them? The terror of a neighbourhood, no matter what age, needs to be confronted. The problem of drugs in a neighbourhood is not confronted. Crime is not reported.

I am my sister's keeper

In small and big things, we are each other's keeper. Jesus is saying something like that today.

Parents can find this difficult as they try to guide the family well and not lose them. We have social responsibility in the family and in our neighbourhood and even worldwide for the common good.

God wants the best for each of us. We can help each other to goodness, we can support each other, advise each other, pray for and with each other, and help each other on our way to God.

*Recall an occasion when someone gave you good advice,
even when you may not have liked it at the beginning.
Be grateful!*

Give me wisdom, Lord, when others ask me for advice or an opinion.

DOWN & CONNOR DIOCESAN TRUST BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE VACANCY "Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator" (2 yr Fixed Term Contract) based within the Jesuit Centre at 193 -195 Donegall Street, Belfast, BT1 2FL. 35 hrs per week (flexibility required), £29k per annum, closing date Thurs 10 September @ 12noon. Full details including application form see <http://www.downandconnor.org> or <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk>

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, DONEGALL STREET, BELFAST @ 6 pm on Sunday, 6 September Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), under the theme "Living Water".

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 AT THE BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE Weekly screenings will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre on 4, 11, 18, 25 Sept, 2, 9, 16 & 23 Oct. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH A Catholic Men's Retreat at Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19 Sept 26, from 9am– 1pm**. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

HLI IRELAND: Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker & popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29 September at 6:45pm, with a Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on Saturdays 26 Sept, 24 Oct & 21 Nov. Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

ANAM CARA, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on **Monday 14 Sept @ 7.30pm** in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast. Online support meeting also available. For more info 01 4045378 or email in-fo@anamcara.ie

MACMILLAN COFFEE MORNING YOU'RE INVITED! Join us for the cause, the chatter or the tasty treats at St Clare's Community Hall on Friday 11 September 2026 between 9.30am – 12pm.

GH TYRES AND AUTO SERVICES: 40a Glenavy Road, Crumlin. Punctures repairs, Wheel Balancing, Wheel Alignment, Batteries, General Service and repairs Tel: 0289 4423 113.

JOIN THE GLENNAVY GARDEN CENTRE TEAM! Seasonal staff to work 16-24 hours per week. If you have interest or know of anyone who might be interested, contact Dominic 07874005422 or email to glenavygardencentre@outlook.com.

ST. JOSEPH'S GAC: Lotto results 28 August 2026 Winning no's 2-10-15-28 Jackpot £7,500. No Jackpot Winner. 2 Lucky dip Winners, £25 each – Fionnuala McLernon – Karen Stockham. Next week's jackpot is worth £7,550. The members of St. Joseph's GAC thank you for your support.



**Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time
6 September 2026**

Very Rev. Rory Sheehan P.P.: St Joseph's Presbytery, 59 Chapel Road, Glenavy, BT29 4LY Tel: 94 422278 (If unavailable and in an emergency only, contact Fr Declan Mulligan P.P. Aghagallon 92 651214)
Parish Office at St Joseph's Glenavy: Monday- Friday 10am -3pm
Parish Support Officer: Joan McShane Tel: 94 422278
Email: glenavy@downandconnor.org
Parish Website: glenavyandkilleadparish.com
www.facebook.com/glenavyandkilleadparish
A member of Lisburn Pastoral Community

Season of Creation 2026

"Future generations will never forgive us if we miss the opportunity to protect our common home. We have inherited a garden; we must not leave a desert for our children."

Joint statement from Pope Francis, the Ecumenical Patriarch Bartholomew and Archbishop Justin Welby of Canterbury.

THEME: "LIVING WATER"

This year's theme, "Living Water", explores Ezekiel 47:9 and 12 as a powerful biblical vision of hope and ecological healing. Set amid exile and loss, the image of living water flowing from God's sanctuary reveals divine healing that renews land, water, biodiversity, and human responsibility towards the whole creation.

"Swarms of living creatures will live wherever the river flows. There will be large numbers of fish, because this water flows there and makes the salt water fresh; so, where the river flows everything will live. [...] Fruit trees of all kinds will grow on both banks of the river. Their leaves will not wither, nor will their fruit fail. Every month they will bear fruit, because the water from the sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will serve for food and their leaves for healing." (Ezek 47:9,12)



PRAYING WITH AWARENESS IN THE SEASON OF CREATION Living among Others Jesus' invites us to stay awake, to seek and respond to the signs of God's loving presence that are all around us. Websites like Sacred Space and Pray-as-you-go follow the structure of the Examen of Consciousness — or Awareness Prayer — in offering guidelines for prayer. The points listed below are to help you heighten your awareness of living in response to God's presence by considering aspects of everyday life. They may enhance your prayer in this Season of Creation as you reflect on them or discuss them with others. **OUR STARTING POINT** The beauty of creation reflects the infinite beauty of the Creator and ought to inspire the respect and submission of man's intellect and will. (Catechism of the Catholic Church, §341) The Catechism teaches that the order, harmony, and beauty we find in creation are not incidental — they point beyond themselves to the Creator who gave them. How do you notice yourself relating to the created world? When have you recently noticed real beauty in creation - something that stopped you, even briefly? What did that moment invite in you? We are commissioned to till and to keep, to work and to guard the garden the Earth (Genesis 2:15): what efforts do you notice yourself making to care for and protect creation?

Tom Layden, S.J.
Chair, Diocesan Ecumenical Commission

7—13 September 2026 Mass Intentions

	<u>ST JOSEPH'S</u>	<u>MATER DEI</u>	St James
Mon	9.30am Communion Service		Monday Adoration 7pm—8pm
Tue		7pm In Honour of Our Lady 6.30pm Rosary 7.30pm Divine Mercy Chaplet 7.30—8.30pm Adoration	
Wed		9.30am Mass of Thanksgiving for Doctors and Nurses in the Cancer Centre 10am—12pm Adoration	
Thurs	9.30am P.I. Adoration 7pm—9pm		
Fri	9.30am In Honour of The Holy Name of Mary		Feumore Mass Centre Sun Adoration 6.30pm—7.30pm Divine Mercy Chaplet, Chaplet for Holy Souls & Rosary afterwards starts at 6.15pm Mon Adoration 11am—12pm
Sat		5.30pm Sacrament of Reconciliation 6pm P.P.	
Sun	9.30am Noel McComb (2nd Anniv) 12.00pm Mass	10.45am Mass	

Recently Deceased Brendan Kevin Flood (*Glengormly*)

Anniversaries Mary Mallon (1st), Hilary McKavanagh, Fidelma Ward, Louis Heatley, Brigid Trowlen, Nathan Crean, Paddy O'Hara, Jim McGarrell, Liam Brankin, Ernie Thomas.

Baptisms We welcome into God's family Cathal John McNamara, Naoise Joseph Morgan, Torin Lewis Damien Stevenson & Kaii Paul Thomas.

Sanctuary Lamps Special Intention, C.H.

A BLESSED STATUE OF OUR LADY OF FATIMA is available through The Legion of Mary to any sick parishioner for one week. If you would like to avail of the statue, please contact the parish office.

Sanctuary lamp intentions: A Sanctuary Lamp burns for a week in each of our two churches. If you would like to dedicate a lamp for a loved one or a special Intention please contact the Parish Office. There is a suggested offering of £5.

Collection 30 August 2026

Weekly Offering: £3,017

Thank you for your generosity

Parish Draw 2026-27 (Week 18)

Winner £50 Seamus Kavanagh (*Crumlin*)

Winner £100 G & M McGarry (*Crumlin*)

Congratulations to our winners!

Following Christ is a 7-week journey in growing in love of God and one another. When Jesus was calling his first Disciples, he said, 'come and follow me'. We receive this calling ourselves today. God comes toward us calling us to himself to be Disciples of Christ. It takes an effort on our part to respond to that call. Will you strive to live the Christian life that Jesus calls you to and make the effort to attend the Following Christ course? It is a course that will help you to understand what it means to be a Disciple of Christ offering practical ways in which to live out your Catholic faith through learning to pray, read scripture, engage in the sacraments and more. The course runs from **7 September to 19 October, 7 – 9pm in Mater Dei Pastoral centre**. The topics covered are; Personal Prayer, Hearing God in Scripture, The Power of the Sacraments, Forgiving One Another, The Spirit-Empowered Life, The Heart of a Disciple and Going on with the Lord. www.christlife.org

CELEBRATING CANON COLM An event will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 at 3pm in St Clare's Hall to celebrate Canon Colm's time with us in Glenavy and Killead parish. The event, which will be an admission free, will comprise of afternoon tea catered by St Clare's Hall team, followed by entertainment. If you would like to attend, please text Rose Crozier by 13 September 2026 on 07720 074213 to confirm your place. If you can contribute in any way to the entertainment, please contact Rose Crozier as above by 13 September 2026 with details. A collection for a gift for Canon Colm will take place on Sunday 6 and 13 September. Envelopes are available at the rear of both churches. Collection boxes will be placed in the porches on 13 and 20 September. Thank you in anticipation of your support.

SEASON OF CREATION 1 SEPTEMBER TO 4 OCTOBER, Feast of St Francis, a dedicated time for Christians to commit to prayer, protection of the environment and care for creation. Volunteers needed for the parish Season of Creation Team, please contact the parish office.

THE CHILDREN'S LITURGY HAS RESUMED We would welcome new helpers. We have a very flexible rota & it is just during term time. If you could help even one Sunday per year, call or email the parish office or speak to one of us at Mass any Sunday.

BALLYMACRICKET PRIMARY SCHOOL 'OUR PAST, OUR PRESENT, OUR FUTURE'

This year Ballymacricket is celebrating its 170th anniversary. As we look at our past, present and future, we'd love your help to remember times gone by. If you have any old photos or stories about the school, please leave them in the school office or email ophillips404@c2kni.net We invite past pupils, families, friends and members of the local community to join us on Sunday 20 September, following 9.30am Mass, in the school hall, to celebrate.

FRIENDS OF THE ORDER Equestrian Order of the Holy Sepulchre of Jerusalem Lieutenancy of Ireland help sustain the living Christian presence in the Holy Land. The Order is a Catholic Order under the protection of the Holy See, dedicated to supporting the Latin Patriarchate of Jerusalem and the Christian communities of the Holy Land. To register your interest as a Friend or to donate holysepulchre.ie/friends, Facebook: [EHOSJ Ireland](https://www.facebook.com/EHOSJ-Ireland) Email: friends@holysepulchre.ie Tel: 086 3253882

Liturgical 'Sign of Peace' The Sign of Peace remains an integral part of the celebration of the Eucharist and has been reintroduced as a normal practice across the Diocese. The customary expression of the Sign of Peace in Ireland is a handshake. However, other non-contact forms of the sign of peace such as a nod, a bow or a smile are also legitimate expressions of the Sign of Peace. No offence should be taken if someone prefers to express a non-contact Sign of Peace. The Diocese encourages all to continue to exercise good hygienic practices, and if you exhibit flu-like symptoms, you are encouraged to remain at home.

Church Webcam The church webcam for live stream of Masses can be accessed via the Parish Website www.glenavyandkilleadparish.com Go to the top line and click on webcams and pick either *Mater Dei* or *Glenavy*. It can also be accessed at www.churchmedia.tv. Select *Antrim* & search for *St Joseph's, Glenavy or Mater Dei, Crumlin* and the churches will appear. Click on the play button to view live stream. The webcams enable us to attend Mass, however they do not allow us to receive the Eucharist, The Body of Christ. When possible, we should attend Mass in the Church whenever our circumstances permit in order to receive Holy Communion.

MUSIC AT ST JOSEPH'S There is an urgent need to recruit an organist or guitarist or pianist, if you or someone you know would be interested in this position please contact Canon McBride as soon as possible.

Making your offering to the church Parishioners are encouraged to make donations to the parish either by using the parish envelopes or by means of bank transfer. It is of great benefit to the parish when we can record donations so that gift aid can be claimed, if applicable. If you would like to donate using envelopes and don't already do so, please contact the parish office. Alternatively, if you are able, you are encouraged to make a monthly offering to the Church by means of a **Bank Transfer to: Parish of Glenavy and Killead Sort Code 98 04 60, Account 10654677**. The relevant forms are available at the back of the Churches. Both forms need to be completed with one sent to your Bank and the other to the parish office. If you have any queries, please contact the Parish Support Officer in confidence. Please note that there is a separate account number for the Parish Draw and this should not be used when making a weekly donation.

DEACONS Those who are discerning a vocation to the permanent diaconate are encouraged to make contact with the Diocesan Director, Rev Brett Lockhart for the Permanent Diaconate, b.lockhart@downandconnor.org.

CCTV CAMERA'S Please be aware that St Joseph's Church and graveyard and Mater Dei Church and grounds are monitored by CCTV.

COFFEE IN THE COURTYARD during the summer months after 10.45am Mass in Mater Dei, weather permitting. Volunteers are needed. If you can help, please contact the Parish office.

SAINT VINCENT DE PAUL—CRUMLIN CONFERENCE (ST JAMES) Emergency helpline 07754427088. Donations can be made via the Crumlin SVP conference bank account. Account number 41965035, sort code 980460. **ST JOSEPH'S GLENNAVY CONFERENCE** SVDP Emergency helpline 07784955647. Donation can be made to our bank account, Sort Code 98-04-60. Account Number 41966009. Your support is very much appreciated as we support those most vulnerable in your local community.



Holy Family Parish

A praying, caring community, centred in Christ

Holy Family Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Patrick’s, Holy Family and St Gerard’s.

MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

Holy Family Church: 6pm Vigil & 10.30am
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 9am & 12noon

WEEKDAYS

Holy Family Church: 9.15am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 10.00am Thursday, Friday & Saturday

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION

Holy Family Church: Saturday 5.15pm-5.45pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Saturday after 10am Mass

BAPTISMS

(Prior booking via Parish Office)

Holy Family Church: Saturdays at 4pm
St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Sundays at 1pm

DEVOTIONS

Eucharistic Adoration: Daily 10am-10pm (St Thérèse)
Pilgrim Prayer: Tuesday 8pm on the Parish Facebook page
Novena to Our Mother of Perpetual Help: Wed 9:15am Mass
First Saturday: 10am (Holy Family)
Taizé Prayer: last Friday of the month 8-9pm (Holy Family)

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Tue 08: The Birthday of the Blessed Virgin Mary
Wed 09: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise
Sat 12: St Ailbe of Munster

“The Birthday of Our Lady – the hope of the entire world and the dawn of salvation.” Pope St Paul VI



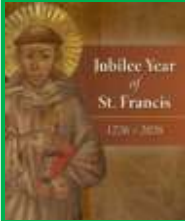
CONTACT INFORMATION

Parish Clergy: Very Rev. Michael Spence PP,
Rev. John O’Lavery CC & Rev. Deacon Brendan Dowd

Parish Telephone (Office hours): 90743119
Office hours: Mon-Thu 9.30am-2.30pm, Fri 9.30am-1.30pm
Address: 226-228 Limestone Road, Belfast BT15 3AP

Emergency Sick Calls only (24hrs): 07928968773
Society of St Vincent de Paul (Helpline): 028 90351561

Email: holyfamily@downandconnor.org
Website & Webcam: www.holy-familyparish.com



23RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

6TH SEPTEMBER 2026
Readings: A (II) Psalter: Week III



The Season of Creation is celebrated each year from September 1 (the World Day of Prayer for Creation) to October 4 (the feast of St. Francis of Assisi).

The Biblical text for this year is drawn from Ezekiel 47: 1- 12, which portrays God’s life-giving water flowing from the temple of God. The river grows deeper and deeper restoring barren land, reviving waters, and sustaining flourishing eco-systems. The vision invites human responsibility: recognising ecological damage, embracing interconnectedness, we are called to immerse ourselves in the water, and actively safeguarding and working for the renewal of creation so that environmental healing and human well-being may flourish together. For more information visit www.seasonofcreation.org or www.laudatosimovement.org

St Colmcille's

Laudato Si' Group

in association with **trócaire**

invite you to join us for

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching, through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

Each event will be in St Colmcille's Parish Hall, 191a Upper Newtownards Road, Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at 7.15 pm

Ending with a supper around 8.45 pm

All are welcome! ♥

6PM MASS ON SUNDAY, 6TH SEPT. IN ST. PATRICK’S CHURCH, DONEGALL STREET. Will celebrate the beginning of the Season of Creation, a time when Christians world-wide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme “Living Water”. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

JUBILEE YEAR OF SAINT FRANCIS

Remember Reverence: “Praised be you, my Lord, through Sister Moon and the stars; in heaven you formed them clear and precious and beautiful.” (St Francis of Assisi)

A Prayer Resource

30 DAYS WITH ST FRANCIS OF ASSISI. To mark this anniversary year, and to prepare for the feast day of St Francis’ on 04th October, this booklet is available from the parish office, price £3. Using the words of St Francis himself, it offers Scripture and short prayers. This simple resource can help us to reflect on the wisdom of St Francis, for today.

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING. The weekly collection on Sunday 30th August came to £2,307.50. Thank you for your continued generosity and support. For information on standing order and contactless methods of donation, please contact the parish office.

PARISH 100 CLUB. Week 17 winners: Marie-Thérèse Morris, Tara Cullinan, Adelaide Moreland & Brenda Killough (Promoter). Congratulations to all the winners.

WEEKDAYS MONDAY 14TH, TUESDAY 15TH & WEDNESDAY 16TH SEPTEMBER: There will be a Gathering for the Priests of Down & Connor in Dromantine for these days. As a result, there will be **No** 9.15am Mass on these mornings. However, Deacon Brendan will be leading a Eucharistic Adoration Prayer Service at 9.15am on each morning. The normal Mass schedule will resume on Thursday 17th September. Apologies for the inconvenience.

NEW LODGE GROTTTO 50TH ANNIVERSARY CELEBRATIONS. Monday 7th September. Rosary at the Grotto at 6.30pm, followed by Mass at 7pm. All welcome.

PUBLIC MEETING ON BUILDING A PRO-LIFE IRELAND. In the Lansdowne Hotel on Thursday 10th September at 7.30pm. Featuring key speakers including Aontú Party Leader Peadar Kirby TD, and Bernadette Smyth of Precious Life.

NEWINGTON CREDIT UNION SEEKS VOLUNTEERS, for the Board of Directors & Supervisory Committee. No previous experience is required. Full training and support will be provided. Contact 028 9035 1040 or E: info@newingtoncreditunion.co.uk.

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG. 19th September. Leaving St Paul’s at 6.30am, returning to St Paul’s at 7.30pm. Retreat £45, bus separate. T: 02890325034 (St Paul’s).

BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE. A Year of Ignatian Prayer. Starts 26th September; Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available. Registration required. *The Chosen – Season 2.* Weekly screenings on Fridays at 10.45am, which started 4th September. And job vacancy for *Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator.* For all, visit belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk.

THE OLD PAROCHIAL HOUSE AT ST THÉRÈSE CHURCH. Sincere thanks to all those who organised and supported Dom Polski, to make last Sunday’s garden party such a great success.

EXCITING PARISH EVENT COMING UP.

Please save the date.

Sunday 4th October at 7pm

Details to follow.

REST IN PEACE

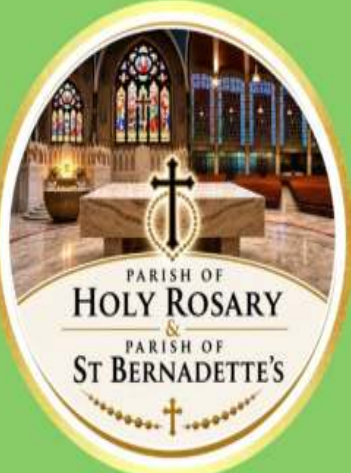
Recently Deceased: Jordan Flannery
Month’s Mind: Jim O’Connor
Anniversaries: James Richard Hann, Anne Rogan, David Parker (20th), Patricia O’Hare, Barney Deery, Maureen McGrath, Joe Magee (1st), Mary Snow, Bridie May, Joanne Morgan, William Madden (1st), Eoin Loughran, Bernadette Gillen, John & Sally Murphy, Frank McGoldrick, Mary Collins

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!

For more information and resources:
www.holy-familyparish.com

MASS INTENTIONS

Sat 5 (6pm):	For the People of the Parish
Sun 6 (9am):	Priest’s Intention
Sun 6 (10.30am):	Mary Snow & Bridie May
Sun 6 (12 Noon):	Joanne Morgan
Mon 7:	William Madden (1 st)
Tue 8:	Bernadette Gillen
Wed 9:	Jim O’Connor MM
Thu 10:	John & Sally Murphy
Fri 11:	Priest’s Intention
Sat 12 (10am):	Geraldine Hart



MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

ST BERNADETTE'S PARISH
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am

HOLY ROSARY PARISH
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Holy Rosary Church: Third Sunday of the month at 2p.m.
St Bernadette's Church: First Saturday of the month at 2p.m.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland, PP (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed Assistant Priest
(028) 9079 3023.

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

COME AND SING WITH US!

St. Bernadette's Parish Choir is looking for new members! We return to our musical duties on **Sunday 6th September**, singing each week at the **11.00am Sunday Mass**, with a rehearsal beforehand.

There are no auditions, and you don't need to be an experienced singer - just someone who enjoys singing and would like to be part of our choir. We warmly welcome singers of all ages, so if you've ever thought about joining us, now is the perfect time to give it a try!

For more information, speak to Marty Lavery, our organist and choir director, or to any member of the choir.

Down and Connor Cantor Training

Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Dunloy. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 7 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. To request an application form, contact your parish office.



TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

SUNDAY

6th September

Readings: A (I) ♦ Psalter: Week 3



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?

INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY

ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course



When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening. We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat! The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.

To register for '**FOLLOWING CHRIST**' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to **stbrigids@downandconnor.org**

A short information video can be found here:
christlife.org/about/christlife-process/following-christ/

[St Bernadette's Third World Group - Lima Mission](#)

Father Coney and staff members from St Bernadette's Children's Centres in Lima will be speaking at St Bernadette's Masses **Sat 5th & Sunday 6th September**. Their aim is to thank the Sponsors for their continued support over many years, and at the same time promote the sustainability of the projects. The Third World Group is collecting annual sponsorship payments after both Masses this weekend and also on **12th & 13th September**. If you would like to sponsor a child within the Centres please speak to us after Mass. We will be happy to give further details. Many thanks to all sponsors for your continued support.

[FÁILTE - WELCOME GROUP](#)

There will be a get together of the group and new members in the coffee lounge (St Bernadette's parish centre) on the **13th September after 11am mass**. We are blessed to have 16 members and would be delighted if more parishioners came along to join us. You will find it to be a very worthwhile and enriching ministry to be part of. Beannacht Dia libh.

[HLI Ireland](#)

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

[THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY](#)

The September **Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm** in St. Michael's Parish Centre, The September talk is entitled: "The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918" The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway

[The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre](#)

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: **11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October**. Contact: **bjc@jesuit.ie** 07955 282371

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £1997.00
St. Bernadette's: £1065.52

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend, after Communion. The Building Fund Collection will be taken up next week, in Holy Rosary. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

[St Bernadette's Parish Centre](#)
for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

[Holy Rosary Senior Citizens](#)
Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break on Monday 7th September at 8pm. New members very welcome.

[St Bernadette's Retirement Group](#)
St Vincent de Paul have invited us to join them for their trip to Mount Stewart on Thursday 17th September.
If you're interested please phone Frances 07800562398 or leave your name in the sacristy.
Welcome back after our beautiful summer.
We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on Wednesday 23rd September after Mass.
New members are welcome. £5 registration.
Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark. All members are welcome to join in at any time.

[B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!](#)
18th October & 15th November



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith
Edward (Teddy) Dickson
Thomas (Tommy) Napier
Patrick (Pat) McCarney
Frank Maguire
Gerald (Gerry) Henvey

Anniversaries:

Raymond Glover (6pm)
Laura Heaney (9am)
Denis Carey (10.30am)
Eileen Higgins & Paul Cavana (12.30pm)
David Carville, Joesph Woods,
Francis McGinty

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

Parish of Blaris

Sunday 6th September 2026
The Twenty Third Sunday in Ordinary Time

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

Masses Monday – Friday 10.00am

Saturday Vigil: 6.30pm

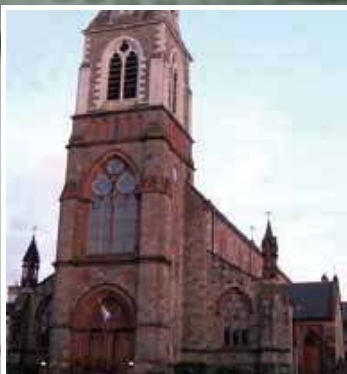
Sunday: 10.00am & 12 noon

LIVE WEBSTREAMING OF ALL MASSES

Please note many parishes in the Diocese have webcams installed which provide live coverage of various Masses taking place daily throughout the Diocese. These can be accessed by visiting www.downandconnor.org Links to Parish Webcams. Live Church webcam links: CHURCH SERVICES. TV & MCN MEDIA CHURCH WEBCAMS

*'For where two or three meet in my name,
I shall be there with them.'*

Matthew 18:20



Fr. Dermot McCaughan, PP: 028 9266 2341
Fr. Eamon Magorrian, CC: 028 9266 2348

Parish Office Opening Hours:
Monday-Friday 10.30am-4.00pm.
Closed 1.00pm-2.00pm.

Parish Office: 028 9266 0206 Fax: 028 9266 5690
Email: lisburn@downandconnor.org
Pastoral Centre: 028 9260 7110
www.parishoflisburn.org

INTRODUCTORY RITES

Congregation stands

**Entrance Hymn or
Entrance Antiphon**

PPs 118: 137, 124

All: You are just, O Lord,
and your judgement is right;
treat your servant in accord with your
merciful love.

GREETING

Priest: In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and
of the Holy Spirit.

All: Amen

Priest: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and
the Lord Jesus Christ.

All: And with your spirit.

PENITENTIAL ACT

Priest: Brothers and sisters, let us acknowledge our sins,
and so prepare ourselves to celebrate the sacred
mysteries.

All: I confess to almighty God
and to you, my brothers and sisters,
that I have greatly sinned,
in my thoughts and in my words, in what I
have done and in what I have failed to do,

Striking your breast as you say:

through my fault, through my fault,
through my most grievous fault;
therefore I ask blessed Mary ever-Virgin,
all the Angels and Saints,
and you, my brothers and sisters,
to pray for me to the Lord our God.

Priest: May almighty God have mercy on us,
forgive us our sins,
and bring us to everlasting life.

All: Amen

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy.
Christ, have mercy.
Lord, have mercy.

GLORIA

All: Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.

We praise you, we bless you,
we adore you, we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.

Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,
you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us;
you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer;
you are seated at the right hand of the Father,
have mercy on us.

For you alone are the Holy One, you alone are the
Lord, you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ, with the Holy Spirit, in the glory of
God the Father. Amen.

THE COLLECT

Priest: Let us pray.

Pause for silent prayer

Priest: O God, by whom we are redeemed and receive
adoption, look graciously upon your beloved sons
and daughters, that those who believe in Christ
may receive true freedom
and an everlasting inheritance.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the
Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever.

All: Amen.

THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

Congregation Sits

FIRST READING

A reading from the prophet Ezekiel

33:7-9

The word of the Lord was addressed to me as follows, 'Son
of man, I have appointed you as sentry to the House of
Israel. When you hear a word from my mouth, warn them
in my name. If I say to a wicked man: Wicked wretch, you
are to die, and you do not speak to warn the wicked man to
renounce his ways, then he shall die for his sin, but I will
hold you responsible for his death. If, however, you do
warn a wicked man to renounce his ways and repent, and
he does not repent, then he shall die for his sin, but you
yourself will have saved your life.'

All: The word of the Lord
Thanks be to God.

RESPONSORIAL PSALM

Ps 94:1-2. 6-9. R v.8

(R) O that today you would listen to his voice!
Harden not your hearts.

1. Come, ring out our joy to the Lord;
hail the rock who saves us.
Let us come before him, giving thanks,
with songs let us hail the Lord. **(R)**

2. Come in; let us bow and bend low;
let us kneel before the God who made us
for he is our God and we
the people who belong to his pasture,
the flock that is led by his hand. **(R)**

3. O that today you would listen to his voice!
'Harden not your hearts as at Meribah,
as on that day at Massah in the desert,
when your fathers put me to the test;
when they tried me, though they saw my work. **(R)**

SECOND READING

A reading from the letter of St Paul to the Romans

13.8-10

Avoid getting into debt, except the debt of mutual love. If
you love your fellow men you have carried out your
obligations. All the commandments: You shall not commit
adultery, you shall not kill, you shall not steal, you shall not
covet, and so on, are summed up in this single command:
You must love your neighbour as yourself. Love is the one
thing that cannot hurt your neighbour; that is why it is the
answer to every one of the commandments.

All: The word of the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Congregation stands

ACCLAMATION

Jn 17:17

All: Alleluia, alleluia!
Your word is truth, O Lord,
consecrate us in the truth.
Alleluia!

GOSPEL

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: A reading from the holy
Gospel according to Matthew

18:15-20

All: **Glory to you, O Lord.**

Jesus said to his disciples: 'If your brother does something wrong, go and have it out with him alone, between your two selves. If he listens to you, you have won back your brother. If he does not listen, take one or two others along with you: the evidence of two or three witnesses is required to sustain any charge. But if he refuses to listen to these, report it to the community: and if he refuses to listen to the community, treat him like a pagan or a tax collector.

'I tell you solemnly, whatever you bind on earth shall be considered bound in heaven; whatever you loose on earth shall be considered loosed in heaven.

'I tell you solemnly once again, if two of you on earth agree to ask anything at all, it will be granted to you by my Father in heaven. For where two or three meet in my name, I shall be there with them.'

The Gospel of the Lord.

All: **Praise to you Lord Jesus Christ.**

Congregation sits

HOMILY

Congregation stand

THE CREED

All: **I believe in one God,
the Father almighty,
maker of heaven and earth,
of all things visible and invisible.**

**I believe in one Lord Jesus Christ,
the Only Begotten Son of God,
born of the Father before all ages.
God from God, Light from Light,
true God from true God,
begotten, not made, consubstantial with the
Father; through him all things were made
For us men and for our salvation
he came down from heaven,**

(bow your head up to the words 'and became man')

**and by the Holy Spirit was incarnate of the Virgin
Mary, and became man.**

**For our sake he was crucified under Pontius
Pilate, he suffered death and was buried,
and rose again on the third day
in accordance with the Scriptures.
He ascended into heaven
and is seated at the right hand of the Father.**

**He will come again in glory
to judge the living and the dead**

and his kingdom will have no end.

**I believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of
life, who proceeds from the Father and the Son,
who with the Father and the Son is adored and
glorified, who has spoken through the prophets.**

**I believe in one, holy, catholic and apostolic
Church. I confess one Baptism for the forgiveness
of sins and I look forward to the resurrection of
the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.**

PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL

Congregation sits

THE LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Offertory Procession

*The gifts of bread and wine which will become the Lord's body
and blood are brought to the altar.*

The celebrant raises the host on the paten saying:

Priest: Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the bread we offer you:
fruit of the earth and work of human hands,
it will become for us the bread of life.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

*The celebrant pours wine and a little water into the
chalice, saying quietly:*

Priest: By the mystery of this water and wine
may we come to share in the divinity of Christ
who humbled himself to share in our humanity.

*The celebrant then raises the chalice above the
altar and says:*

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation,
for through your goodness we have received
the wine we offer you:
fruit of the vine and work of human hands,
it will become our spiritual drink.

All: **Blessed be God for ever.**

Bowing, the celebrant says quietly:

Priest: With humble spirit and contrite heart
may we be accepted by you, O Lord,
and may our sacrifice in your sight this day
be pleasing to you, Lord God.

Then the celebrant washes his hands, saying quietly:

Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity
and cleanse me from my sin.

Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and
yours may be acceptable to God,
the almighty Father.

All: **May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands
for the praise and glory of his name, for our
good and the good of all his holy Church.**

PRAYER OVER THE OFFERINGS

Priest: O God, who give us the gift of true prayer and of peace, graciously grant that through this offering, we may do fitting homage to your divine majesty and, by partaking of the sacred mystery, we may be faithfully united in mind and heart. Through Christ our Lord.

All: **Amen**

Congregation stands

EUCCHARISTIC PRAYER III

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: Lift up your hearts.

All: **We lift them up to the Lord.**

Priest: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

All: **It is right and just.**

PREFACE (VI of Ordinary Time)

Priest: It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give you thanks, Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God.

For in you we live and move and have our being, and while in this body we not only experience the daily effects of your care, but even now possess the pledge of life eternal.

For, having received the first fruits of the Spirit, through whom you raised up Jesus from the dead, we hope for an everlasting share in the Paschal Mystery.

And so, with all the Angels, we praise you, as in joyful celebration we acclaim:

ACCLAMATION

All: **Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts.
Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.
Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.**

Priest: You are indeed Holy, O Lord, and all you have created rightly gives you praise, for through your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, by the power and working of the Holy Spirit, you give life to all things and make them holy, and you never cease to gather a people to yourself, so that from the rising of the sun to its setting a pure sacrifice may be offered to your name.

Therefore, O Lord, we humbly implore you: by the same Spirit graciously make holy these gifts we have brought to you for consecration, that they may become the Body and + Blood of your Son our Lord Jesus Christ, at whose command we celebrate these mysteries.

For on the night he was betrayed he himself took bread, and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, broke the bread and gave it to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND EAT OF IT,
FOR THIS IS MY BODY
WHICH WILL BE GIVEN UP FOR YOU.

In a similar way, when supper was ended, he took the chalice and, giving you thanks, he said the blessing, and gave the chalice to his disciples, saying:

TAKE THIS, ALL OF YOU, AND DRINK FROM IT,
FOR THIS IS THE CHALICE OF MY BLOOD,
THE BLOOD OF THE NEW AND ETERNAL
COVENANT, WHICH WILL BE POURED OUT FOR
YOU AND FOR MANY FOR THE FORGIVENESS
OF SINS.

DO THIS IN MEMORY OF ME.

Priest: The mystery of faith.

All: **Save us, Saviour of the world,
for by your Cross and Resurrection
you have set us free.**

Priest: Therefore, O Lord, as we celebrate the memorial of the saving Passion of your Son, his wondrous Resurrection and Ascension into heaven, and as we look forward to his second coming, we offer you in thanksgiving this holy and living sacrifice.

Look, we pray, upon the oblation of your Church and, recognising the sacrificial Victim by whose death you willed to reconcile us to yourself, grant that we, who are nourished by the Body and Blood of your Son and filled with his Holy Spirit, may become one body, one spirit in Christ.

May he make of us an eternal offering to you, so that we may obtain an inheritance with your elect, especially with the most Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God, with blessed Joseph, her spouse, with your blessed Apostles and glorious Martyrs with Saint Patrick and with all the Saints, on whose constant intercession in your presence we rely for unfailing help.

May this Sacrifice of our reconciliation, we pray, O Lord, advance the peace and salvation of all the world. Be pleased to confirm in faith and charity your pilgrim Church on earth, with your servant Leo our Pope and **N** our Bishop, the Order of Bishops, all the clergy, and the entire people you have gained for your own.

Listen graciously to the prayers of this family, whom you have summoned before you: in your compassion, O merciful Father, gather to yourself all your children scattered throughout the world. To our departed brothers and sisters and to all who were pleasing to you at their passing from this life, give kind admittance to your kingdom. There we hope to enjoy for ever the fullness of your glory through Christ our Lord, through whom you bestow on the world all that is good.

Priest: Through him, and with him, and in him, O God, almighty Father, in the unity of the Holy Spirit,

All: all glory and honour is yours,
for ever and ever.
Amen.

Congregation stands

THE COMMUNION RITE

Priest: At the Saviour's command
and formed by divine teaching,
we dare to say:

All: **Our Father, who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.**

Priest: Deliver us, Lord, we pray, from every evil,
graciously grant peace in our days,
that, by the help of your mercy,
we may be always free from sin
and safe from all distress,
as we await the blessed hope
and the coming of our Saviour, Jesus Christ.

All: **For the kingdom, the power and the glory
are yours now and for ever.**

Priest: Lord Jesus Christ, who said to your Apostles:
Peace I leave you, my peace I give you,
look not on our sins, but on the faith of your Church,
and graciously grant her peace and unity
in accordance with your will.
Who live and reign for ever and ever.

All: **Amen.**

Priest: The peace of the Lord be with you always.
All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May this mingling of the Body and Blood of our Lord
Jesus Christ bring eternal life to us who receive it.

All: **Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, have mercy on us.
Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the
world, grant us peace.**

Congregation kneels

The celebrant says quietly:

Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God,
who, by the will of the Father
and the work of the Holy Spirit,
through your Death gave life to the world,
free me by this, your most holy Body and Blood,
from all my sins and from every evil;
keep me always faithful to your commandments,
and never let me be parted from you.

INVITATION TO HOLY COMMUNION

Priest: Behold the Lamb of God,
behold him who takes away the sins of the world.
Blessed are those called to the supper of the Lamb.

All: **Lord, I am not worthy
that you should enter under my roof,
but only say the word
and my soul shall be healed.**

Priest: May the Body of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

Priest: May the Blood of Christ
keep me safe for eternal life.

COMMUNION ANTIPHON

Cf. Ps 41:2-3

All: **Like the deer that yearns for running streams,
so my soul is yearning for you, my God;
my soul is thirsting for God, the living God.**

Purifying the chalice the celebrant says quietly:
What has passed our lips as food, O Lord,
may we possess in purity of heart,
that what has been given to us in time
may be our healing for eternity.

PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION

Congregation kneels

Priest: Let us pray.
Grant that your faithful, O Lord,
whom you nourish and endow with life
through the food of your Word and heavenly
Sacrament, may so benefit from your beloved Son's
great gifts that we may merit an eternal share in his
life. Who lives and reigns for ever and ever.

All: **Amen**

THE CONCLUDING RITES

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: **And with your spirit.**

Priest: May the peace of God,
which surpasses all understanding,
keep your hearts and minds
in the knowledge and love of God,
and of his Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

All: **Amen**

Priest: And may the blessing of almighty God,
the Father, and the Son, + and the Holy Spirit,
come down on you and remain with you for ever.

All: **Amen**

Then the celebrant, with hands joined and facing the people, says:

Priest: Go in peace.

All: **Thanks be to God.**

Imprimatur – nihil obstat: + Most Rev. Alan McGuckian, SJ, Bishop of Down and Connor. Excerpts from the English translation of The Roman Missal © 2010, International Committee on English in the Liturgy Corporation. All rights reserved. Jerusalem Bible version of the scriptures copyright: Darton, Longman & Todd Ltd and Doubleday & Co. Inc. Responsorial Psalms are copyright The Grail and/or Geoffrey Chapman Ltd. Created and published by Tara Lees, 1 Lille Park, Belfast, BT10 0LR. T: 02890302817. E: tarabooklet@gmail.com.



We remember our beloved dead:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Mona Mulholland: Ted Rooney.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY: Cathy McMullan

ANNIVERSARIES: Pat Loughran: Matthew McKibben: Mary Wilson: Gerald (Gerry) McGrath:
Fr Denis Newberry: Ernie Gordon: Elizabeth Gallagher: Michael McGann: Gerald & Sheila Kelly:
Tommy Catney: Claire Fox: Magdalene Lagan.

THIS WEEK'S CALENDAR

Tuesday 8th September – The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday 9th September – St Ciaran, Abbot

Saturday 12 September – The Holy Name of Mary

INDIAN CATHOLIC COMMUNITY

Mass in Syro-Malabar Rite will be celebrated in St. Patrick's Church at 3pm this afternoon, 6th September.



CHILDREN'S LITURGY will commence again on Sunday 13th September 2026 during 10am Mass. This group welcomes all children from 4-11 years of age (Primary 1 to Primary 7). Please note that you must register your child/children **BEFORE** this date. If you would like your child to be registered, there will be a registration session on **Sunday 6th September before and after 10am Mass in the Pastoral Centre**. If a child has not been registered they cannot attend. If you already registered your child last year, you do not need to re-register. Additionally, if you would like to be part of our Children's Liturgy Team of Volunteers, please contact the Parish Office. We look forward to welcoming the children back in September.

**New Suzuki Method baby/
toddler class**
Unique in Ireland
Suitable from birth- age 3
Friday 9:30 Parish Centre



"Babies who participated in the interactive music classes (Suzuki Baby/Toddler classes) showed earlier sensitivity to the pitch structure in music. The non-musical differences between the two groups of babies were even more surprising, say researchers. Babies from the interactive classes showed better early communication skills, they smiled more, were easier to soothe, and showed less distress with unfamiliar things."

Contact Keri
07709495255
Suzuki Method NI

PIC • COLLAGE

SCRIPTURE GROUP resumes after our summer break on Tuesday 8th September .

We meet in the Parish Pastoral Centre every Tuesday 7:30 - 8:30 to study, discuss and reflect on the Mass readings for the following weekend.

A YEAR OF IGNATIAN PRAYER 2026-2027 – BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in **Ignatian Spirituality**, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online **Integrative Practice Pause Points** to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: **£200–£280**. Bursaries available.

For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

THE CHOSEN – SEASON 2 AT THE BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required. Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake.

Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs.

BULLETIN NOTICES AND ANNIVERSARIES

Bulletin Notices should be with the Parish Office by 12 noon on Monday to be included in the weekend bulletin.

Please note all emails to Parish Office should be addressed to –
lisburn@downandconnor.org

**DOWN AND CONNOR DIOCESAN TRUST
BELFAST JESUIT CENTRE**

Vacancy "Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator"

The Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator will support the Director of the Belfast Jesuit Centre & Chaplain to the Ulster University, Belfast. Full details relating to the vacancy can be found on the Diocesan website at www.downandconnor.org clicking on the tab: Job Vacancies, also of the Community NI website: belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk and nijob.com

THINKING ABOUT BECOMING CATHOLIC OR WANT TO DEEPEN YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF THE FAITH?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

CALLED & GIFTED - DISCOVER YOUR SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Have you ever wondered how God might be working in your life, or what gifts He has given you to use for others? Called and Gifted is a guided process to help you discern the Spiritual gifts you received at your Baptism, and how God is calling you to use them.

We invite you to journey with others to discover:

- Who God is calling you to be: How the Holy Spirit is at work in your life
- The unique gifts you have been given to share with others.

Where?

- 120 Cliftonville Road, Belfast **When?** Saturday 26 Sept, 9.30am-4pm: Wednesday 21st Oct, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 4th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Wednesday 18th Nov, 7pm-9pm: Saturday 5th Dec, 9.30am-4pm
- Cost: £50 per person

Attendance on all training dates is required. This training involves the use of online resources so requires access to a laptop, tablet or smartphone and a basic level of digital skills. **Please click on the link to register to attend by 11 Sept 2026.** <https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/EbEJb01BDs> If you require further information, please contact us at: email: pathwaystothefuture@downandconnor.org Tel: (028) 9069 0920.



COFFEE MORNING

In aid of the Anthony Nolan Appeal on Sunday 13th September 10.30am – 1.30pm. Everyone welcome.

ST PATRICK'S GAC

Senior Ladies started off their Championship with an emphatic win. Next up for them is the short trip to Davitt Park to take on Davitts this evening (Sun 6th September) with throw in at 6pm.

Last weekend we had the wonderful "Festival of Football" which saw around 400 children from 15 different clubs take part in an underage tournament. Congratulations to U10.5 St Patrick's team who won the Cup.

Commiserations to the U8.5 St Patrick's team who were runners up.

Congratulations are also due to the U16 girls team who recently won the league.

This was a fantastic achievement for the girls and management team - Well done.

*Lord, may everything we do this day
begin with your blessing and continue with your help.
May everything we say this day begin with your love
and continue with your grace.
May everything we plan this day begin with your inspiration
and continue with your peace.
So that throughout our lives all that we begin in you may be happily ended,
all that we fail to do may by you be mercifully mended,
and all that we seek though you may by you be lovingly attended. Amen.
Prayer Trust.*

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SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER 2026
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
 Sunday Cycle A, Psalter Week 3



✦ MASS TIMES & LITURGIES

OUR LADY OF THE ASSUMPTION CHURCH NEWCASTLE

WEEKDAY MASSES:

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri at 10am

LITURGY OF THE WORD & HOLY COMMUNION: Wed & Sat 10am

WEEKEND MASSES:

Saturday Vigil Mass at 6pm & Sunday Mass at 11.30am

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH

BRYANSFORD: Open for Private Prayer Only. Open daily from 10am To 5pm

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION:

Fridays, 10.30am-5.00pm

CONFESSIONS

1st & 3rd Saturday, 3.30-4.00pm

BAPTISMS: 1st & 3rd Sat, 3-3.30pm. Book in sacristy after Mass. Bring long birth certificate

WEDDINGS: Arrange with Fr Jim after Mass. Weddings can also be arranged in St Patrick's, Bryansford.

The Parish of Maghera is a part of the Diocese of Down and Connor Trust and operates in accordance with the Diocesan policies. Registered UK Charity No. **XN46141** Charity Name: **Down and Connor Diocesan Trust**

✦ FAMILY OF PARISHES

Parish of Dundrum & Tyrella

Mon-Thurs 9.30am; Sat 10am [Dundrum];

Fri 9.30am [Ballykinkor];

Saturday Vigil 6pm [Ballykinkor];

Sunday Mass 11am [Dundrum]

Parish of Kilmegan & Kilcoo

St. Malachy's Church, Castlewellan

Mon, Tues, Thurs, Fri 9.30am

Saturday Vigil 5pm

Sunday 10am

[Kilcoo]; Sat Vigil 5pm & Sun Mass 10.00am [Kilcoo];

Mon 9.30am; Wed-Fri 9.30am

Tues 9.30am [Aughlinsnafin]

✦ CONTACT DETAILS

PARISH PRIEST: FR JIM CRUDDEN

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 028 437 22401

PARISH MANAGER: BRENDA WEBB

Parochial House 24 Downs Road Newcastle 07840 028461

emails: bwebb@downandconnor.org / brenda@parishofmaghera.com

PARISH SUPPORT & FINANCE

OFFICER: VIRGINIA HUGHES

(On annual leave)

Parish Office, Parochial House, 24 Downs Road, Newcastle, BT33 0AG. Tel: 028 437 22401

Office Hours: Tue-Fri 10am-1pm (Closed Monday). Emails:

Newcastle@downandconnor.org / parishoffice@parishofmaghera.com

Web: www.parishofmaghera.com

FB: Parish of Maghera D&C

To access the Parish webcam:

<https://www.mcni.live/camera/our-lady-of-the-assumption-church-newcastle>

SACRISTANS: STEPHEN BODEN /

ANTHONY CREELMAN

Tel: 028 4372 7691 (after Mass)

PARISH SHOP: EUGENE SMALL

14 Main Street - 028 4372 3399

Opening Time: Mon, Tue, Thu, Fri, Sat - 10.30am-4.30pm (Closed Wednesday)

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& ST PATRICK'S HALL: EAMON

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4372 3399, Office Hours Mon,

Wed & Fri 9.30am-1.30pm

Email: newcastlebookings@downandconnor.org

SAFEGUARDING. If you have a

concern, suspicion or wish to

report an allegation of abuse,

please contact: Philip O'Hara,

Diocesan Designated Liaison

Person, 120 Cliftonville Rd,

Belfast BT14 6LA Tel: 07534991124

E: philip.ohara@soddc.org

SVT IF YOU ARE IN NEED OF HELP

Please Contact the St Vincent

de Paul Helpline: 07889780330 or

Lifeline on: 0808 808 8000

✦ MINISTRY OF WELCOME

RECENTLY BAPTISED

Cian Nina / Callan Michael / Rosie Mae / Niamh Christina

BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY

Please remember in your prayers:

RECENTLY DECEASED: Danny Donnan / Cathal McKibbin

ANNIVERSARIES: Derek Murphy /

Catherine Kane / Teresa

McCrickard / Deacon Mark

Leneghan

✦ MASS INTENTIONS

SAT, 5TH - 13TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Sat, 5th 6pm Sheila McEvoy

Sun, 6th 11.30am Fiona, Margaret

& Seamus McKibbin / Thomas &

Anne Walsh / Peter O'Hare /

Annie McQuillan

Mon, 7th 10am Gabrielle Kerr

Fri, 11th 10am Madeleine Blaney

Sat, 12th 6pm Mary McKibbin /

John Harbinson

Sun, 13th 6pm Joseph McFall

"May their souls and the souls of all the

faithful departed rest in peace."

✦ SANCTUARY CANDLES

This week's Sanctuary Candles will

burn for: Fiona, Margaret &

Seamus McKibbin

✦ OFFERTORY COLLECTIONS

16 Aug 2026: £2390.82, Standing

Order: £671.83, Total: £3062.65,

Diocesan Cathedral Fund:

£339.45, Standing Order: £55,

Total: £394.45, Diocesan

Sundries collection (additional)

£464, Holy Day: £703.01. **23 Aug**

2026: £2397.92, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £3069.75. **30 Aug**

2026: £2253.95, Standing Order:

£671.83, Total: £2925.78,

Diocesan Sundries collection:

(additional) £427.05, Thank you.

Pope Leo's prayer intention.

September 2026: Water

Management - Let us pray for a

just and sustainable management

of water, a vital resource, so that

everyone may have equal access

to it.

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Parish Office Contact Numbers and Email Addresses

Christ the Redeemer	02890309011	christtheredeemer@downandconnor.org
Derriaghy	028 92660073	derriaghy@downandconnor.org
Nativity	028 90625739	nativity@downandconnor.org
OLQP	028 90616300	ourladyqueenofpeace@downandconnor.org
St Luke's	028 90625739	stlukes@downandconnor.org
St Anne's	02890610112	stannes@downandconnor.org

Pope Leo's prayer intentions for August: For evangelisation in the city.

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.



The Sacrament of Baptism in Our Lady Queen of Peace will be on the **second Saturday of each month at 2.30pm.**

All parents are required to attend a Pre Baptism meeting which is held on the third Tuesday of each month at 7pm in St Colman's.

KNIT & NATTER: Our Lady Queen of Peace Knit & Natter re-opens on Wednesday 3rd Sept 10.30-12pm. All new members welcome.

If there is anyone in the parish who is **sick and housebound** and would like a priest to visit, please contact the parish office or email kilweeparish@gmail.com

PLEASE NOTE the parish office will be closed this Tuesday & Wednesday.

CAMINO -PARISH PILGRIMAGE

There will be a special pilgrim prayer box in the foyer of our Lady Queen of Peace, Kilwee, for you to place your written intentions. Our pilgrims will physically carry these in their day packs, lifting you up in prayer as they walk, as they reflect together and at the tomb of St. James in Santiago.



ANNIVERSARIES Bridie, Billy and Bernard Rooney
 We pray for those whose anniversaries occur around this time
Eternal rest grant unto them O Lord and may perpetual light shine upon them

FIRST SATURDAY DEVOTIONS will take place in St. Matthias's Church, Glen Road on Saturday, 5th September 2026 3.00 p.m. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament Confessions Act of Consecration 4.00 p.m. Holy Sacrifice of the Mass

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE
ourladyqueenofpeacekilwee.com **DONATE BUTTON**
 If you require a box of envelopes, please contact the Parish Office 90616300

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student €55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

MATT TALBOT – URBAN MYSTIC

The **Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick**, invite you to a special screening of *Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic* at **Newcastle Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle**, on **Friday 4th September at 7.00pm.**

Matt Talbot's remarkable true story of **faith, struggle, addiction and redemption** continues to inspire people throughout the world and offers a powerful message of hope to those affected by addiction and their families.

The evening will also feature **guest speaker Michael Murphy.**

Admission is free, with a suggested donation of **£3 towards costs.** Tea and coffee will be served following the screening. Everyone is welcome -please bring family and friends.

URGENT: STOP ASSISTED SUICIDE - postcards available

The vote on assisted suicide is on 11 September. *Not Dead Yet UK* have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September.

Please take action now - collect a red and white postcard, fill out your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

ROSARY VIGIL FOR LIFE - outside Belfast City Hall on Sunday 30th August at

2.00pm. Join Precious Life in prayer to uphold the sacredness and dignity of unborn life, and pray that Belfast Council will reject plans to illuminate the City Hall in celebration of abortion. For more information, **contact 028 9027 8484 / 07592 280522 or email info@preciouslife.com.**

FIRST SATURDAY DEVOTIONS will take place in St. Matthias's Church, Glen Road on Saturday, 5th September 2026 3.00 p.m. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament Confessions Act of Consecration 4.00 p.m. Holy Sacrifice of the Mass

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.



**ST. PATRICK'S BALLYPHILIP
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
Sunday 6th September 2026**



**Fr Feargal McGrady PP Tel: 028 427 28234 Web: www.portaferryparish.com
Email: portaferry@downandconnor.org Livestream: www.churchmedia.tv
Parish Office: 028 427 28373, Monday – Friday 9.00am – 1.00pm**

Parish Bereavement Ministry

This group offers support for anyone experiencing bereavement. If you would like to talk to a member please Telephone: 07564293692

**ST PATRICK'S COMMUNITY CENTRE CONTACTS:
MADELINE DYNES 07999945936 & JAMES MAGEE 07542530006
During Business Hours**

	St Patrick's Portaferry	St Cooley's Oratory	St Patrick's Ballygalget
Sunday 6 th September TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME	11am Mass		9.30am Mass
Monday 7 th September		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Novena Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Tuesday 8 th September Nativity of Mary			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Wednesday 9 th September St Ciaran		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Thursday 10 th September St Peter Claver			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Friday 11 th September	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass	Eucharistic Adoration 10.00am – 6.00pm	7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass
Saturday 12 th September The Holy Name of Mary St Ailbe	5.45pm Adoration 6.30pm Vigil Mass		5.00pm Vigil Mass

Our prayers are requested for the happy repose of the soul of Bernadette Cooper, recently deceased and for the following whose anniversaries occur around this time:

Annie Murray, William Breen, Nancy McHenry, Seamus Smyth, Patsy Andrews, Harry Andrews, Nora McAlister, Margaret Craig, Letitia McVeigh, Catherine Morrin, Sarah McCormick, Annita Crawford, Ena Quinn, Ronan & Muriel Curran, Bobby Adair (Senior), John Savage.

May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace, Amen.

FIRST SATURDAY PRAYERS: will continue Saturday 5th September at 9.30am in St. Cooley's Oratory. As requested by Our Lady at Fatima, the Rosary and Consecration Prayer will be recited.

MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday 5th September: **Annie Murray, William Breen, Bridie Savage**
Sunday 6th September: **Eamon Fitzsimmons (Months Mind), Nancy McHenry**
Monday 7th September: **Seamus Smyth**
Saturday 12th September: **Paddy Smyth, Dominic Pucci**
Sunday 13th September: **Oliver Lynch**

HARVEST SERVICE in Portaferry Methodist Church, Sunday 27th September at 7pm, Rev Alan Wardlow, the Past President of the Methodist Church in Ireland will lead the service alongside other local church leaders. A joint churches choir will help us in our music as we thank God for his goodness to us. Light refreshments provided after the service. Food or financial gifts will be welcome but must be shelf stable goods that will be donated to the local Food Bank. These can be brought to the church Sat morning 26th at 09:30-10:30am or brought on Sunday evening to the service.



If you are having difficulties with your expenses ring our confidential telephone: 07508 549701. We can help.
Donations for the month of August came to £2,205.00.
Thank you for your support and generosity.

Weekly Offering: £1,405.00 (Last week's Weekly collection was £1,441.00)
Thank you for your continued support and generosity.



PORTAFERRY AND BALLYGALGET BAPTISM MINISTRY

Baptism Information sessions will begin after Halloween. Dates will depend on Baptisms that are booked via the Parish office.

Parents/ Guardians/ Godparents and Grandparents will be invited to attend. The information sessions will be:

- Short
- Informal
- Explain the rite of Baptism
- Provide refreshments
- Provide a welcome gift for each child.

Over the next few weeks, we will be setting up 'Baptism trees' in St Patrick's Portaferry and St Patrick's Ballygalget beside the Baptismal fonts. The name of each child to be baptised will be hung on the tree as a welcoming gesture from our Parish communities.

May the time of preparation for Baptism be filled with peace, gratitude and the loving presence of God in our families.

The Folk Group returns this Sunday 6 September at 11.00 mass.

We would welcome new members, young (from P6) and anyone else who enjoys music and singing and might like to try out being part of a choir.

Anyone interested in joining us please come along any Sunday and learn as you go.

Contact Bernie Doran on 078 4992 7581 or Lorna Spence on 078 5064 8091.

Notices for the parish bulletin need to be with the parish office by Wednesday 12noon.
Anniversary notices can be left in the anniversary boxes in either church,
(Boxes beside the candle shrines), sent by email, or rang into the office.

St. Patrick's Community Centre, Portaferry
NEW FOR AUTUMN – Week Beginning 7th September

- Mon.** Tea and Chat, Gentle Exercise, Whist, Quiz 11.00am Text 07873284252
Guitar for Improvers 12.30pm Text 07999945936
Ferry Fit 6.45pm
Ferry Fit 7.45pm
- Tues.** Portaferry Crafters (Textiles) 10.30am Text 07999945936
Netball for P5 to Year10. 6.30pm to 7.30pm Text 07542530006
Ceili Dancing 7.15pm Text 07395200128
Ukulele Beginners 6.30pm; Improvers 7.15pm Text 07999945936
- Wed.** Fit 4 ALL 9.30am (Gently Does It) Text 07999945936
Judo 5.00pm Text 07929905310
- Thurs.** Community Centre Singers 10.30am Text 07999945936
Jo Jingles 12.00pm Text 07395200128
The Hive (Arts & Crafts) 12.30pm Text 07999945936
"Painting Portraits" coming soon 7pm. Watch out for details.
Ferry Film Club (Last Thursday in the month) 7.00pm
Family Film "Song of the Sea" 27th August @7.00pm
Ferry Fit 8.00pm
- Fri.** Party Dance 9.30am Text 07999945936
Walking Group 11.00am
- Sat.** Flower Arranging (1st Sat of each month) 12 noon text 07999945936



Next Bingo Sunday 13th September at 3pm in aid of Air Ambulance.

See our Face Book page for further details: [Stpatrickscmmunitycentreportaferry](#) or text the relevant number with your details and the activity which interests you.

To hire any of our six rooms, please text [07542530006](#) or [07999945936](#)

St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit, Portaferry.
Could You Spare an Hour?

As we begin another new school year, St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit is seeking volunteers from our parish and wider community to help enrich the lives of our children. Whether you could support reading, maths activities, sports coaching, art, languages, gardening or simply share a skill, hobby or life experience, even a small amount of your time can make a meaningful difference.

If you can spare one hour a week, one hour a month, or help with a particular project, we would love to hear from you.

Contact the school on 028427 28278 or email pgilchrist570@c2kni.net

Share your time. Share your talents. Help our children learn, grow and shine.

BAPTISMS: Portaferry Parish: 2nd & 4th Sunday of the month

Ballygalget Parish: 1st & 3rd Sunday

Please book with the parish office, (**Not the parochial house.**) Portaferry: 02842728373

Mon - Fri 9am - 1pm. Ballygalget: 07398623134 Wed or Fri 9am -1pm.

A copy of your child's Birth Certificate (Long version) is required prior to Baptism date.

BALLYGALGET, PORTAFERRY & ARDKEEN PARISHES

Day Out

FAITH, HERITAGE & COMMUNITY

Explore. Experience. Enjoy Together.



A SHEPHERD'S LIFE AT GLENSHANE COUNTRY FARM
SHEEP SHEARING DEMONSTRATION

Step into the past and experience life on the farm. Watch a live **sheep shearing** demonstration and see working sheepdogs, **hold baby lambs** and more.



THE GORTA EXPERIENCE AT FRIELS

A powerful and moving visitor experience that brings the story of the Great Famine to life.



DINNER AT FRIELS BAR & RESTAURANT, SWATRAGH

Relax and enjoy a delicious **3-course dinner** in the warm and welcoming surroundings of Friels.



TRAVEL IN COMFORT WITH CONNECTIONS IRELAND

- ✓ Modern, luxury coach
- ✓ Air conditioning
- ✓ Spacious seating
- ✓ Friendly, professional driver

PRICE:

£60

PER PERSON
Includes coach travel, all admissions & 3-course dinner

FULLY GUIDED THROUGHOUT THE DAY
Our day out will be fully guided throughout by a professional tour guide accredited by Tour Guides Northern Ireland.

TOUR GUIDES NORTHERN IRELAND

DATE:
THURSDAY
24 SEPTEMBER 2026

DEPARTURE:
LEAVING PORTAFERRY SQUARE AT 9.00 AM SHARP

RETURN:
APPROX. 6.00 PM

WHO CAN JOIN?
Open to everyone in the Parishes of Ballygalget, Portaferry & Ardkeen.

TO SECURE YOUR PLACE CONTACT:
SEAMUS DORRIAN
ON 07813968171

ALL PLACES ALLOCATED ON A FIRST COME FIRST SERVED BASIS.
Don't miss out - book early to avoid disappointment!

Together in Faith. Together in Community.

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **Trócaire**
— invite you to join us for —
Heroes for Humanity
— of —
A series of workshops exploring
the principles of Catholic Social Teaching
through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at
7.15 pm

Ending with a cuppa
around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. This event will take place online on Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.

We are joined by an exceptional panel of local organisations and experts in sibling bereavement.

Michelle Hartnett is a senior play therapist, systemic practitioner, and bereavement specialist currently working with LauraLynn, Ireland's Children's Hospice, with over 15 years' experience supporting families through serious illness, grief, and loss. Michelle holds an MSc in Systemic Therapy and an MSc in Bereavement Studies and is a Grief Consultant with Middlesex University. She also holds a postgraduate certificate and diploma in Play Therapy from NUI Galway.

Anna May is founder of The Student Grief Network and Executive Head of Grief Programmes at Kaplan International. She lost her brother as a child and her dad as a young adult and is passionate about improving the support that people get following a bereavement. Anna is also a writer and artist, interested in how creativity can help us explore difficult human experiences and build more connected ways of living.

We are also joined by Childhood Cancer Ireland, Jacinta's Smile, and Rainbows.

In the world of grief and loss, siblings, especially adult siblings, are often called 'forgotten mourners.' Siblings face not only their own loss, but often the loss of their parents and families as they knew them, the loss of the only person who was present of their whole life, and often the loss of a close friend. We believe this is why it is essential to begin forming an all-island bereavement support for adult siblings facing all kinds of sibling loss. We hope you can join us in this effort by sharing about this Bereavement Information Evening with your community.

Bereaved parents and adult bereaved siblings are warmly invited to register here:
[Register here for Anam Cara Online Bereavement Information Evening](#)



6th September 2026

THE PARISHES OF PORTSTEWART, PORTRUSH & BUSHMILLS & ST. MALACHY'S COLERAINE

North Connor Pastoral Community

Fr Kevin McGuckien PP Telephone: 028 7083 2534 Email: k.mcguickien@downandconnor.org
TWENTY THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME



Sunday A / Psalter Week 3

MASS TIMES

STAR OF THE SEA CHURCH, PORTSTEWART

TUESDAY: 7.00pm
WEDNESDAY – FRIDAY: 9.30am
SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm
SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am

CONFESSION:

SATURDAY: 4.00pm

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - THURSDAY 10am-5pm

ST. MALACHY'S CHURCH, COLERAINE

TUES, THURS & SAT: 10.00am

PLEASE NOTE THERE IS NO MASS IN ST. MALACHY'S CHURCH ON FRIDAY THIS COMING WEEK

SUNDAY MASS: 11.30am & 5.00pm

CONFESSION:

SATURDAYS: After 10.00am Mass

SUNDAYS: 4.30-4.50pm

ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, PORTRUSH

MON, TUES & FRI: 10.30am

SUNDAY MASS: 12 Noon

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - FRIDAY 11am-1pm

OUR LADY & ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, BALLYMONEY

MON & WED: 10.00am

FRIDAY: 7.00pm

SATURDAY VIGIL MASS: 6.00pm

SUNDAY MASS: 9.30am

COLLECTIONS

PORTSTEWART

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £1750

Our account details are: Portstewart Parish
Sort Code: 95-04-28 Account number: 91011049

PORTRUSH

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £697

Our account details are: Portrush Parish
Sort Code: 95-06-79 Account number: 00254207

ST. MALACHY'S COLERAINE

Last weekend's Collections: Weekly Offering: £1458

Our account details are: St Malachy's Church
Sort Code: 90-48-00 Account number: 88609151

THANK YOU FOR YOUR SUPPORT AND GENEROSITY!

PORTSTEWART

Parish Support Officer: 028 7083 2534

Email: portstewart@downandconnor.org

Parish Office Hours: Mon 9.00am -1.00pm

Tues 2.00pm-5.00pm, Wed & Fri: 9.00am – 5.00pm

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Dr. James Harley, Jody Campbell, Paul O'Neill, Sean Hughes, Stacey McLaughlin, Bill O'Doherty, Brian McCaffrey, Mary Convery, Mark Oakley RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Margaret Lynch, Fearghal Devlin, Tony Doherty, Jean Loughrey, Sarah Sweeney, Andrew Diamond, Reggie Smyth, Teresa McClarnon, Sarah Brown, Paddy McGarry, John Mullan, Bobby Stuart, Maryanne McCrory RIP

NEXT WEEKEND – 12 & 13 SEPT (PORTSTEWART)

VIGIL MASS: 4.30pm

Minister of the Word: Seamus O'Hara

Eucharistic Ministers: Ruth McGuckian, Tracy McMorrough, Alison Rankin/Deirdre McCann

SUNDAY MASS: 10.00am

Minister of the Word: Curtis White

Eucharistic Ministers: Julie Roantree*, Deirdre Bannon*, Mark Donaghy*, Liam Brolly

COLERAINE

Email: coleraine@downandconnor.org

Parish Office: Thurs: 9.00 – 5.00pm

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Vincent McGuigan, Roisin Ward, Eileen Morrison, Suzanne McEvoy RIP

ONE YEAR AGO: Paul Duffy RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Rose Young, Sarah Brown, James Crawford, Mary McGill, Brian Kneeland, Margaret Kneeland, Patricia McMullan, Andrew Diamond RIP

PORTRUSH

Fr Patrick Delargy: 028 7082 3388

Email: portrush@downandconnor.org

PARISH OFFICE: Tuesday – 9.00am-1.00pm

NEXT SUNDAY – 13 SEPT (PORTRUSH) 12.00 Noon

Minister of the Word: Kate Magee

Eucharistic Minister: Marie McAuley

REST IN PEACE

RECENT: Gerard Britovšek, Helen Scullion RIP

ANNIVERSARIES: Fr. John Madden PP, Sarah Brown, Brian Minihan RIP

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH



A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19

September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme

of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. **For further info, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435/email sean@catholicminute.co.uk**



HEALTHY AND SMART CHILDREN FOUNDATION

Dr Christian will be making an appeal for his charity at the weekend Masses in Portrush and Ballymoney next weekend. 12th & 13th Sept. Fund raising for the GOD'S GIFT OF SIGHT project, to provide free cataract surgeries for 100 blind people and 3,000 pairs of glasses for poor people in churches and communities in Nigeria.

Charity Name: Healthy And Smart Children Foundation

Bank Name: Charity Aid Foundation Bank

Account Number: 73016017 **Sort code:** 405240

You can also make direct debit to support our charity in the care for many poor children in

Africa www.healthysmartchildren.org



ST. PATRICK'S INDOOR BOWLING CLUB

Our Bowling Club will commence bowling on Sunday 13th September at 7.00 pm in St. Patrick's Hall, Portrush. This year the League has been restructured into 3 Sections meaning there will be fewer Inter-club matches and more nights for social bowling. Anyone wishing to join the Club come along on Sunday 13th or any Sunday that suits. If you are new to the sport, we have Bowls available, and members will make you welcome.



BLESSING OF ANIMALS

Once again, our Family of Parishes will be marking the Church's Season of Creation with a blessing of pets and animals. This year the blessing takes place in the grounds of Our Lady & St Patrick's in Ballymoney on Sunday 27th September at 2pm. All welcome to attend.



We are blessed to be able to offer two opportunities to our parish community to honour Our Blessed Mother Mary. Parishioners are warmly invited to join either pilgrimage, depending on what suits your schedule and spiritual needs. Both are beautiful opportunities to enjoy time away from the noise and busyness of our lives and immerse ourselves into a day of prayer and reflection.





SACRED HEART PARISH
Sunday 6th September 2026
23rd of Ordinary Time



Deacon: Joe Baxter

Parish Office: 1B Glenview Street, Belfast, BT14 7DP
Email: sacredheart@downandconnor.org
Phone: 028 9075 1543
Emergency Phone Number: 07427189388
Hours open: 9am-2pm , Mon, Tues, Wed, Fri
Parish Support Officer: Cathy Carroll
Sacristan: Collette Delaney
Acolyte: Thomas Liddy
Parish Webpage: <https://www.sacredheartparishbelfast.com>
Webcam [sacredheartparishbelfast.com/Webcam](https://www.sacredheartparishbelfast.com/Webcam)

~Mass Times~
Saturday Vigil: 6.00pm: Vigil Maura & Tommy Roscoe, Anniversary Mass
Sunday Masses: 9.30am: Patrick McKeever, Anniversary Mass
11.30am: Fr Newberry, Anniversary Mass
Weekday Masses: Monday 11.30am John Donnelly RIP, Funeral Mass
Tuesday 7.00pm: Novena Angela Fox, Anniversary Mass
Wednesday 10.00am: Kevin Cassidy, Month's Mind Mass
Confessions & Adoration: Saturday: 5.00pm - 6.00pm.
Divine Mercy: Friday 2.15pm, Exposition, Prayer and Confessions

~Sacrament of Baptism~
Baptisms are held on the 1st & 3rd Sundays of each month, at 12.30pm.
Please contact the parish office to arrange a baptism.

~Sacrament of Marriage~
Please contact the Parish Office to arrange.

~Upcoming Feast Days~
5th September
St Teresa of Kolkata
8th September
Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary
9th September
St Ciaran

**~Recently Deceased~**
John Donnelly
Siobhan Walker
Mary Johnson
Martin Dunlop
Danny Deeds
Patrick Pryor
Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord

~Sanctuary Candles~
Mary Johnson
Charles Grant
Thomas McCrudden
Annie Brady
Colette Donaldson
The MacQuillan Family
A Donation of £5 per candle is greatly appreciated

~Weekly Collection~
£1202.51
~Sr Speight Collection~
£3000.00

The Parish Thanks You
For Your Kindness And Generosity

~Anniversaries~
Kera Crawford
Christine Donnelly (nee Burns)
Bill Winter
Peggy Winter
Sean Winter
Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord



~Baptisms~
Welcome into our community

Theo Wallace
Caoimhin Og Corr



~A Spiritual Communion~
Jesus, I believe that you are present in the **Most Blessed Sacrament**. I love You above all things, and I desire to receive You into my soul. Since I cannot now receive You Sacramentally, come at least spiritually into my heart, I embrace You as if you are already there, and I unite myself wholly to You.

The Lord asks of you only this, that you act justly, love tenderly and walk humbly with your God.
(Micah 6:8)

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

Pope Leo's Prayer Intentions for 2026 ***August: For Evangelisation in the City***

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.
Amen

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation. 6pm, Sunday 6th September, St. Patrick's Church, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. Marking the beginning of the Season of Creation, 1 Sept–4 Oct, when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue." All welcome.

St Joseph Men's Camino. Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland, Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch, dinner. Speaker: Fr Mark Quinn. Open to men 18+. Cost €65 (student €55). Registration details can be found at www.dominicans.ie/events or op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

St Colmcille's Laudato Si' Group
in association with **TRÓCAIRE**
invite you to join us for

Heroes for Humanity
A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

Each event will be in **St Colmcille's Parish Hall**
391a Upper Drumcree Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

All are welcome!

Wednesday
9 September 2026
Saint Oscar Romero

Wednesday
16 September 2026
Sister Dorothy Stang

Wednesday
23 September 2026
Dorothy Day

Wednesday
30 September 2026
Martin Luther King Jr

Beginning at 7.15 pm

Ending with a supper around 8.45 pm

Urgent: Stop assisted suicide. We now have just over 2 weeks left before MPs will vote at the Second Reading of the assisted suicide Bill in the House of Commons on September 11th. Not Dead Yet UK have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September. Please take action now—collect a red and white postcard, fill in your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

The Chosen – Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/ coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; Episode dates: 11, 18 & 25 Sept, 2, 9 & 16 Oct. Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk .All welcome

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach.

Portglenone Monastery, Saturday 19th September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is 'It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me'. (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

A Year of Ignatian Prayer

Saturday
14th Sept
10.00am
Ignatian
Belfast Jesuit
Centre

Wednesday
24th Sept
7.00pm
Retreat
Integrative
Practical
Prayer Hours

18th September

19th October

27th November

9th December

10th January

6th February

4th March

10th April

8th May

8th June

27th October

17th November

16th December

20th January

13th February

Sacrosanct

23rd April

10th May

10th May

Book your place
Register at
www.belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk
or call 07955 282371

JESUIT

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September. A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down & Connor will take place on: Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast. This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who would like to support a fresh start, new energy, and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Day Retreat to Lough Derg. Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's Church, Fall's Rd at 6.30am and returning at 7.30pm. Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival, light lunch and retreat. Price: £45 + bus (price determined on uptake. Call St Paul's Parish on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs to register.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those not baptised, baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith. The programme begins Wednesday 1st October, weekly, 6.30–8pm, St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend with participants. All welcome, whether you're exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register: email rcia@downandconnor.org

Mass cards are available from the office. £2.50 each

Chatty Café. Wednesday 10.30am -12.30pm. Come join us for a cuppa & a chat.

AA Meeting upstairs in the Parish Centre every Monday & Friday, 6.30pm-7.30pm, and Thursday at 7pm. (Ladies Group)

Cocaine Anonymous (CA) meet every Tuesday at 7pm upstairs in the Parish Centre.

The Spred Group are finished for the Summer and will rejoin on Monday 7th September at 7pm.

The Stitch and Crocheting Group meet Thursday evenings, 7pm in the Parish centre. Come along and learn a new skill.

Lifeline-24hr 7 days a week 0808 808 8000
Samaritans anytime night or day 116 123
St Vincent De Paul 028 90351561
Cancer Lifeline 028 90 351999
AA 02890351222

AI-Anon Family Groups 028 9068 2368
PIPS 0800 088 6042
Youth Education Health Advise 02890 757 809
Diocesan Safeguarding Officer Philip O'Hara 07534 992 124

Sacred Heart of Jesus, I place all my trust in Thee

**Downpatrick Family of Parishes
Parishes of Saul & Ballee and Kilclief**

**Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time
Sunday 6th September 2026**

Mass Schedule for the coming week:

Date	St Patrick's Saul	Stella Maris Strangford	St Joseph's Ballycruttle	St Malachy's Kilclief	St Tassach's Carlin
Sunday 6 th Sept	9.30am		12noon	11am	
Monday 7 th Sept	10am	7.30pm			
Tuesday 8 th Sept	10am				
Weds 9 th Sept	10am				
Thursday 10 th Sept					
Friday 11 th Sept	7pm			9.30am	
Saturday 12 th Sept	5pm	6.30pm			
Sunday 13 th Sept	9.30am			11am	12noon

Masses are available to view online at www.saulandballeeparish.com and www.churchmedia.tv

Eucharistic Adoration in St Patrick's Church, Saul each Tuesday after 10am Mass concluding at 8pm. Holy Hour from 2-3pm

Our Lady of Knock Novena each Monday evening in Stella Maris, Strangford at 7.10pm.

The Sanctuary Lamp in St Patrick's Church, Saul has been lit for private intentions. If you would like it lit for your intentions please contact the Parish office. The cost is £5 per week.

Eucharistic Adoration

Down & Connor Diocese is renewing and developing its *Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee* in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in Parishes throughout the Diocese. You are welcome to attend an information meeting on Friday 2nd October in St Patrick's Centre, Downpatrick at 8pm. Registration from 7.30pm. Please see the poster in the Churches for further details.

We invite you all to join us for a cup of tea and biscuits after 7pm Mass on Friday 11th September in St Patrick's PS, Saul to celebrate Fr Aidans 40th Anniversary of his Ordination to the Priesthood.

Start of School Term Masses will be celebrated as follows:-

St Patrick's PS, Saul on Monday 7th September at 10am

St Malachy's PS, Kilclief on Friday 11th September at 9.30am

Recently Deceased: John Lundy

Parish of Saul & Ballee

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Kenny Kelly, Thomas & Elizabeth McCormick

Sunday 6th September – Michael Burns (12noon)

Wednesday 9th September – Spencer Cusack

Friday 11th September – Niall Laverty

Saturday 12th September – James Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Raymond Blaney (12noon)

Saturday 19th September -Dermot Vint

Sunday 20th September – Patrick Grant (12noon)

Parish of Kilclief

Anniversary Masses

Saturday 5th September – Jason Hynds

Sunday 13th September – Kevin Cultra, Seamus McMorro, Mary Polley, Patrick King

Saturday 19th September – Anna & William Shields

	Saul & Ballee	Kilclief
Weekly Collection	£1,822.20	£

Hymns – St Malachy's, Kilclief

Entrance: 348v1 Praise to the Lord

Offertory: 183v1 I am the bread of life

Communion: 466v1, 2 You shall cross the barren desert

Recessional: 175v1 Go to the Mass is ended

Hymns - St Patrick's, Saul

Entrance – 240 Do not be afraid

Offertory – 256 Fill my house

Communion – 165 Be still for the presence of the Lord

Recessional – 330 He's got the whole world in his hands

Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:-

Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am, Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am

To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723

IT COULD BE YOU!!!

I am deeply indebted to all the volunteers we have in our 2 Parishes. In fact, we could not function without each of you.

One of the biggest fears that prevent people from volunteering is that they could still be there in 15 years time!!

I don't want that for anyone which is why I am making this appeal.

We are always looking for new volunteers –

- For practical things such as cleaning our churches, helping with the flowers, collectors and counters.
- For the roles of Eucharistic Minister or readers, especially from the younger members of our congregations.
- For the various committees in the Parishes, I can assure you we try to keep the meetings brief and not too often.

If you would be interested, I'd love to hear from you – even to explain what the various roles entail. I am eager to revamp our Parish Pastoral Councils. To look at what can be done to make our Parishes and our celebrations more vibrant and meaningful.

Thank you all for your continued support.

Fr Aidan

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach - a Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Day Retreat to Lough Derg on Saturday 19th September. Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..

MYMY is an accredited counselling service for adults based in Newcastle. If you or someone you know could benefit from counselling please give us call on 028 4372 7549, email hello@mymy.org.uk or self-refer via our website."

St Joseph Men's Camino - *Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1st October and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



Opening Mass for the Season of Creation - 6.00 pm on Sunday 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall Street, Belfast. Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions. This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4 Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action for our common home under the theme "Living Water". 1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to "beat swords into ploughshares" (*Is* 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

SAFEGUARDING - If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: philip.ohara@soddc.org or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>

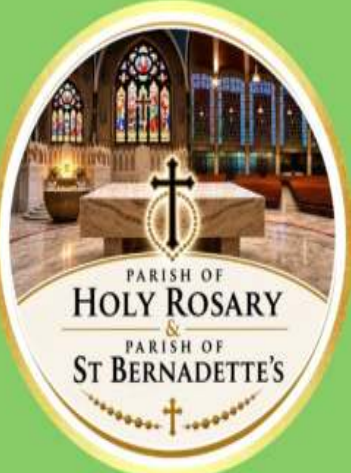
Very Rev Fr Aidan Brankin, Parish Priest 02844 612525 (Saul) or 02844 260101 (Strangford)

Saul Office: 02844 612525, Office Hours: Mon to Fri 9.30am to 12noon 10 St Patrick's Rd, Downpatrick, BT30 7JG

Kilclief Office: 02844260101 Office Hours: Monday 1pm to 3pm 8 Shore Rd, Strangford, BT30 7NL

Website: www.saulandballeeparish.com

Email: saul@downandconnor.org strangfordandkilclief@downandconnor.org



MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

ST BERNADETTE'S PARISH
Vigil 6.00pm & 11am

HOLY ROSARY PARISH
9am, 10.30am & 12.30pm

WEEKDAYS
St Bernadette's Parish:
Mon, Tues & Wed 9.30am
Holy Rosary Parish:
Thurs, Fri & Sat 10.00am

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION
Good Shepherd church Saturday **10.30am**
St. Bernadette's church Saturday **5.15pm**

BAPTISMS
(Prior booking via Parish Office)
Holy Rosary Church: Third Sunday of the month at 2p.m.
St Bernadette's Church: First Saturday of the month at 2p.m.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Fr. Brendan Hickland, PP (028) 90642446 (Option 1)
b.hickland@downandconnor.org

Fr. Babu Panattuparambil Vareed Assistant Priest
(028) 9079 3023.

Rev. Patrick Keown (Deacon) p.keown@downandconnor.org

Kylee (Parish Support Officer) Office Hours
Mon-Thurs 9.15a.m - 1p.m. Closed Fridays

Holy Rosary Parish Office (028) 90642446 Option 2
holyrosary@downandconnor.org

Philomena (Finance Officer) p.dawson@downandconnor.org
More Information and resources:
holyrosaryparishbelfast.net and www.st.bernadettesparish.org

COME AND SING WITH US!

St. Bernadette's Parish Choir is looking for new members! We return to our musical duties on **Sunday 6th September**, singing each week at the **11.00am Sunday Mass**, with a rehearsal beforehand.

There are no auditions, and you don't need to be an experienced singer - just someone who enjoys singing and would like to be part of our choir. We warmly welcome singers of all ages, so if you've ever thought about joining us, now is the perfect time to give it a try!

For more information, speak to Marty Lavery, our organist and choir director, or to any member of the choir.

Down and Connor Cantor Training

Adults (18+) involved in parish music are invited to take part in Cantor Training at St Joseph's Parish Centre, Dunloy. Training takes place on Saturday 3 October, 17 October and 7 November, from 10.00am to 3.00pm (registration from 9.30am). Attendance at all three days is required for commissioning as a parish cantor. To request an application form, contact your parish office.



TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

SUNDAY

6th September

Readings: A (I) ♦ Psalter: Week 3



? LIFE AFTER ALPHA ?

INVITATION TO CONTINUE THE JOURNEY

ChristLife 'FOLLOWING CHRIST' Course



When Jesus called his first Disciples he said, "Come Follow Me." He still makes that call to us today. The 'ChristLife' series is an opportunity for you to respond to that call and continue that journey you embarked upon with Alpha. **FOLLOWING CHRIST** is a 7-week course with a one day Retreat to help you grow as a disciple of Jesus. The course will commence on **TUESDAY 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 at 7:00pm** in **HOLY ROSARY PARISH CENTRE, 503 Ormeau Road, BT7 3GR.**

Each evening will follow a format similar to the Alpha Course and include a video presentation and small group discussions each evening.

We will also have time for tea and coffee and a little something to eat!

The evening should last no more than a couple of hours.

To register for '**FOLLOWING CHRIST**' course, please send your full name, your e-mail address and preferably your mobile telephone number to **stbrigids@downandconnor.org**

A short information video can be found here:
christlife.org/about/christlife-process/following-christ/

[St Bernadette's Third World Group - Lima Mission](#)

Father Coney and staff members from St Bernadette's Children's Centres in Lima will be speaking at St Bernadette's Masses **Sat 5th & Sunday 6th September**. Their aim is to thank the Sponsors for their continued support over many years, and at the same time promote the sustainability of the projects. The Third World Group is collecting annual sponsorship payments after both Masses this weekend and also on **12th & 13th September**. If you would like to sponsor a child within the Centres please speak to us after Mass. We will be happy to give further details.

Many thanks to all sponsors for your continued support.

[FÁILTE - WELCOME GROUP](#)

There will be a get together of the group and new members in the coffee lounge (St Bernadette's parish centre) on the **13th September after 11am mass**. We are blessed to have 16 members and would be delighted if more parishioners came along to join us. You will find it to be a very worthwhile and enriching ministry to be part of. Beannacht Dia libh.

[HLI Ireland](#)

Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

[THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY](#)

The September **Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm** in St. Michael's Parish Centre, The September talk is entitled: "The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918" The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway

[The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre](#)

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: **11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.** Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie 07955 282371

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY COLLECTION:

Holy Rosary: £1997.00
St. Bernadette's: £1065.52

Many thanks for your continued generosity and support

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend, after Communion. The Building Fund Collection will be taken up next week, in Holy Rosary. Collection offering can be made by standing order or the Dona machines in the church porch.

[St Bernadette's Parish Centre](#)
for all bookings and enquiries please email:
stbernadettes@downandconnor.org

[Holy Rosary Senior Citizens](#)

Senior Citizens monthly meet-up returns after summer break on Monday 7th September at 8pm. New members very welcome.

[St Bernadette's Retirement Group](#)

St Vincent de Paul have invited us to join them for their trip to Mount Stewart on Thursday 17th September.

If you're interested please phone Frances 07800562398 or leave your name in the sacristy.

Welcome back after our beautiful summer.

We hope to see you at our next coffee morning on Wednesday 23rd September after Mass.

New members are welcome. £5 registration.

Our Thursday weekly walk: we meet at 10:15 in the church carpark. All members are welcome to join in at any time.

[B.I.N.G.O is back, we're hoping for a FULL HOUSE!](#)
18th October & 15th November



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased:

Georgia Ann Nugent
Joesph Rollins
Michael McKinney
Philip Smith
Edward (Teddy) Dickson
Thomas (Tommy) Napier
Patrick (Pat) McCarney
Frank Maguire
Gerald (Gerry) Henvey

Anniversaries:

Raymond Glover (6pm)
Laura Heaney (9am)
Denis Carey (10.30am)
Eileen Higgins & Paul Cavana (12.30pm)
David Carville, Joesph Woods,
Francis McGinty

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord



PARISH OF ST COLMCILLE'S BALLYHACKAMORE

*"To know the joy
of God's love and
make the love of
God known to all"*

23RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME- YEAR A

6TH SEP 2026

Missal Pg 647

WELCOME BACK!

As September begins, we hope that everyone has had a restful and enjoyable summer. It is wonderful to welcome everyone back, and there is a real sense of excitement about all that lies ahead in the life of our parish.

This year, rather than welcoming a NET Team, we are delighted to be appointing our own Youth Minister, Brendan, who will work with our young people and families and help us continue to develop this important part of our parish mission. We very much look forward to welcoming Brendan and to seeing all that will grow from his ministry among us.

The summer has also given us an opportunity to focus particularly on parish leadership and renewal. We have welcomed new members to our Parish Engagement Group (PEG), and we are continuing to develop our Four Ws, helping to ensure that the many different groups, ministries and organisations which make up our parish remain connected to one another and, above all, to our shared mission.

As the next step, I would like to invite the leader or one representative from every group, ministry, committee or organisation connected with our parish to a Four Ws gathering on Tuesday 29th September at 7.30pm in the Parish Centre.

This includes not only our explicitly pastoral or liturgical ministries, but the many groups and organisations who meet in or use our parish facilities. If you are part of the life of this parish, you are part of our mission.

If you lead or represent one of these groups, please contact the Parish Office for further details and to let us know that your group will be represented.

There is much to look forward to in the months ahead. May we begin this new parish year with renewed energy, working together to build a community where everyone is welcomed, valued and invited to share in the mission of proclaiming the Gospel.

Have a blessed week, Fr Conor



MASS THIS SUNDAY

First Reading: Ezekiel 33:7-9

Psalm 94

*O that today you would listen to his voice!
'Harden not your hearts.'*

Second Reading: Romans 13:8-10

Gospel Acclamation

*Alleluia, alleluia! Your word is truth, O
Lord: consecrate us in the truth.
Alleluia!*

Gospel: Matthew 16: 21-27

THIS WEEK AT ST COLMCILLE'S

SUN	Mass: 9.30am & 11.30am
MON	Morning Prayer: 9.00am
TUE	Holy Hour, Confessions: 6.00pm Mass: 7.00pm.
WED	Mass: 9.30am
THU	Mass: 9.30am
FRI	Morning Prayer: 9.00am, Mass: 9.30am
SAT	Confession: 5.00pm – 5.20pm, Mass: 5.30pm

DECEASED

We pray for the repose of the souls of all those who have died recently.

ANNIVERSARIES

We also remember in prayer all those whose anniversaries occur at this time:

Maureen Forrester, David O'Flaherty and Jack Younger.

Lost Property

A collection of clothing left in the church hall is currently on display on the long bench in the church foyer.

If you have lost an item, please check the collection and claim it by **Saturday 12th September**. Any unclaimed items after this date will be disposed of.

St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **Trócaire**

Heroes for Humanity

A SERIES OF WORKSHOPS

**WEDNESDAY
9 SEPTEMBER
2026**

Saint Oscar Romero
A workshop exploring the life and legacy of a voice for **justice** and the poor.

St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

Beginning at
7.15 pm

Ending with
a cuppa around
8.45 pm

All are welcome! ♥

Money Matters

The Monthly Offering Collection for the support of the priests will be taken up this weekend.

If you wish to make your contributions via contactless payment, this is now available using the QR code on the parish website or in the bulletin. We would encourage you to gift aid your donation if you are paying tax; you only need to key this information once, as long as you are using the same debit/credit card to make your donations each time.



<https://donate.mydona.com/st-colmcilles-parish-belfast>

Parish Safeguarding Training

1. Full Child Safeguarding Training for Leaders (Level 2)

The dates and links for registration for these training sessions are listed below.

Please note that these are face-to-face sessions taking place locally, and there may not be any further Level 2 Child Safeguarding Training opportunities scheduled in your area this year.

BALLYMENA- Sat 12th September 2026

BELFAST- 16 & 23 Sept 2026

NEWCASTLE- Sat 19 Sept 2026



2. Training in Online Safety

There will be a free online training opportunity provided by CiNI on 8th September 2026 regarding online safety that may be of interest to Leaders of children's and young people's activities.

The 3-hour workshop delivered via zoom is an introduction to the issues surrounding on-line child protection. It looks at harm prevention and protection in the on-line world and how we can enable children to be safe, benefit from this world and protect themselves.

You can book directly with CiNI here:



SAVE THE DATE!

PARISH CEILI

 **FRIDAY 9TH OCTOBER**
7.30PM – 11.30PM
AT COLMCILLES PARISH HALL

 **ADMISSION**
£10.00
PAY AT THE DOOR.

 **BRING YOUR OWN DRINK AND SNACKS.**

 **WE WILL BE HAVING A BALLOT/RAFFLE ON THE NIGHT - ENVELOPES OF 5 TICKETS IS £5.**



Before each dance, there will be a short practice where the caller will explain the steps. During the dance, she'll continue to call out the moves, so no experience is necessary.

HALF THE FUN IS LEARNING THE STEPS TOGETHER!

COME ALONG TO THIS PARISH SOCIAL COMMUNITY EVENT, ENJOY THE DANCING, CRAIC AND FUN.

Parish Group Notices:

John Paul II Award – Information Session

Calling all 16-17 year olds, especially those who have recently finished their GCSEs!

Come along to find out more about this year's John Paul II Award and hear from young people who have recently completed it, sharing their experiences of volunteering and the benefits of the programme.

When: Thursday 17 September at 7pm, Where: Parish Hall – Iona Room

A great opportunity to get involved in parish and community life while gaining a recognised award for your CV and future applications. New members are very welcome!

St Colmcille's Indoor Mixed Bowling Club

Bowling Club resumes on **Thursday 3rd September 26 at 7pm.**

New members are welcome!

Enquiries: Please contact Deirdre on 07479329938, or just turn up!

St Colmcille's Parent & Toddler Group

We provide an opportunity for anyone caring for a child from 0 to 4 years to come along with the child and enjoy company, snacks and play. We meet on Wednesdays at 10 am, and we resume on **Wednesday 9th September 2026** after the summer break. If you haven't been before, it's a great way to make new friends. All mums, dads, grandparents, childminders and carers are welcome, with their children!

Align Physio-led Pilates

Classes will resume **Monday 7th September** in the Parish hall. Class times on a Monday are 9.30am, 10.30am, 7.15pm and 8.15pm. Suitable for all ages, men and women. If interested and for more information, please contact oliviadavidson42@hotmail.co.uk

St Colmcille's Parish Youth Group

The Youth Club returns on **Saturday 12 September at 6.30 pm.**

New and existing members (Years 8–11) are very welcome!

Parents who would like to volunteer and help with the Youth Club are warmly invited to contact Jarek on 07704 410446.

USEFUL CONTACTS

Parish Office: stcolmcilles@downandconnor.org.

Finance Officer: Philomena Dawson - p.dawson@downandconnor.org

Parish Engagement Group - stcolmcillespeg@gmail.com

Webcam: <https://st-colmcilles.net/web-camera/>

Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/stcolmcilleschurch/>

Instagram: [stcolmcillesballyhack](https://www.instagram.com/stcolmcillesballyhack)

Parish Office: Mon- Fri 10:00 - 13:00

Church of St. MacNissi

TWENTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
15TH & 16TH AUGUST 2026

WEEKDAY MASSES - Tuesday-7.00pm,
 Wednesday – Friday 9.30am

WEEKEND MASSES

Saturday 6pm Sunday 10am

CONFESSIONS: On request after all Masses

EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT

Mon-10am-11am Tues - 5:30pm-7pm

LEGION OF MARY Tuesday evening in the
 Parish Centre after Mass. Fatima statue
 visitation. To have the statue in your home or
 to have your intentions prayed for;
 ☎07798865887

PARISH CENTRE

Prayer Meeting - Wednesday 7:45pm

THE ROSARY GROUP each Thurs at 6pm in
 the Church and 'live' online mcn media.

DIVINE MERCY Friday 3pm

MONTHS MIND:

Ali McDowell – Sat 15th Aug 6pm.

ANNIVERSARIES:

Eddie McStravick (1st Anniversary) Sat 15th Aug 6pm
 Teresa Donnelly, Elizabeth McGuigan,
 Shirley Murray, Peggy Donnelly, Charlie Devlin,
 Madge Creighton, John Sawyer, Tom McCormack,
 Thomas Gavin, Thomas Cardwell, Sarah Martin
 Patrick McKenna, Charlie O'Boyle, Brian Kerr,
 Mary Jane Loughran, Annie Hamilton,
 Rosaleen Kelly, Alice Hurrell, Mary Kate Fallon.

INTENTIONS WK BEGINNING 17-August

MONTHS MIND

Joseph McNally – Tue 18th Aug 7pm

ANNIVERSARY MASS

Jim McKenna (1st Anniversary) Sat 22nd Aug 6pm

Our priest is obligated to offer **Sunday Mass**
 on behalf of **ALL** the people (*pro populo*) in the
 parish. The deceased are remembered in our
Prayers of the Faithful.

FEAST DAYS THIS WEEK

Mon 17th Aug – Our Lady of Knock

Wed 19th Aug – St John Eudes

Thur 20th Aug – St Bernard

Sat 22nd Aug - Mary, Queen of Heaven

PARISH WEEKLY COLLECTION £1,279.00

Thank you for your support of our parish.
 To set up a standing order for Direct Debit
 please call or email the parish office to arrange.

MINISTERS OF THE WORD

22/8/26	Geraldine Ibbotson	Sibéal Dumbleton
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EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS

22/8/2026	Vincent O'Connell	Gerard McBride
	Brian Fitzsimon	John Heffron
	David Skelly	Gerard Dougan

Congratulations to

Tasha Craig & John Martin

who had their relationship consecrated in the
 Sacrament of Matrimony on Friday 14th August

CLEANING TEAM 3 on Monday 17th August

SVP Help Line is 0750 854 9606

OFFICE OPEN Monday–Friday 9- 1pm

CONTACT; MOBILE 07734 570890

Or EMAIL randalstown@downandconnor.org

EMERGENCY CONTACT ONLY 07834 383314

PARISH WEBSITE To watch Mass online
 Select WEBCAM from the parish website menu
 or go to mcn.live/cameras/st-macnissis.
 Funerals/weds recorded at the specific request
 of the family

PARISH DRAW FOR AUGUST will be held on
 Wednesday 19th August at 4.30pm in the
 Parochial House.

YOUTH MINISTRY - SPIRIT AND TRUTH !!

every Wednesday in St
 MacNissi's Church
 7pm- 8pm (**Yr 8 – 6th Form Welcome**)



**EVER YOUNG" YOUTH GROUP FOR P7
 LEAVERS** - who will be entering Yr 8 in Sept! @
**St Oliver Plunkett's Church Toome every
 Sunday 4pm - 6pm"**

PILGRIMAGE TO FATIMA Belfast International
 7 Nights F/B Avenida Hotel **14th/21st** August
£845pps. Contact **Joe 07776425631**

KNOCK TRIP 8th & 9th Sep 16 seater bus
 leaving St. MacNissi's Church at 8.am. Luncheon
 en-route, evening meal and b & b at
 Knock House Hotel £185pps. (night stay)
Contact 07519915325

"MEDJUGORJE YOUTH PILGRIMAGE 2027:

Our Youth Minister Dean Millar will be taking a group of young people aged 14 - 18 from Antrim, Randalstown & Duneane Parishes to Medjugorje next summer. If you would be interested in this, please share an expression of interest with Dean at d.millar@downandconnor.org or via Whatsapp at 07593 925676

August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg
A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life of faith, for it removes us from our daily routines, and gives us time and space to encounter God more deeply. Pope Leo XIV

One Day Retreats – Guided Days of Prayer and Reflection - places available on August 18th, 22nd, 23rd, 29th and 31st September 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th and 20th Admission €50. Group discounts available. Advance Booking Essential .

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry City**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

St Joseph Men's Camino Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

The **Knights of St Columbanus, CK12 Downpatrick**, invite you to a special screening of *Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic* at **Newcastle Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street, Newcastle**, on **Friday 4th September at 7.00pm**. Admission is free.

MONDAY WEEKLY SALSA CLASSES

7-8pm in Tir na nÓg old clubhouse. All welcome, no partner required Contact 07713388035

THURSDAY 10.30am Our **WALKING CLUB** meets at the Parish Centre. Welcome Tea and Coffee on return.

TÍR NA NÓG LOTTO Tues 11/08/2026

JACKPOT WINNER:

WINNING NUMBERS: 6,13,18,26

£25 WINNERS: Rory McVeigh, Marg D Bunting, Michael McNally, Dermot Corr.

Jackpot
£5,000

Next week
Tues 18/08/2026

Kickham's GAC Wed 12/08/2026

WINNING NUMBERS: 4,8,19,24

£30 WINNERS:

Yvonne Loughran & Frances Bateson

Next week's draw is on Wednesday 19/08/2026 at 8.30pm. Tickets must be bought by 7.30pm.

Jackpot £6,400 Tickets are available online at <https://member.clubspot.app/club/creggan-kickhams-gac/fundraisers> from outlets in town or your usual ticket sellers.

COMMUNITY ADVICE Antrim and N'Abbey (Formerly Citizens Advice)

Monday from 1.30pm to 4.30pm, in Arches. No appointment needed as this is a *drop-in* service

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND (2-4 OCT 2026)

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the "Focolare Centre" "Curryhills", Prosperous, Co. Kildare.

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

• www.marriageencounter.ie

Mass Times This Week



Monday 10.00am Eucharistic Prayer

Service

Tuesday – Friday 10.00am Mass

Wednesday 7.00pm Novena Mass

Saturday 5.00pm Vigil

Sunday 11.00am Mass



Adoration of The Blessed Sacrament will take place after 10.00am Mass on Wednesday & Friday



Sunday evenings from 6.00–7.30pm, a time of intercession for vocations, with a special hour of prayer and reflection. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament throughout. All are very welcome.

St Michael the Archangel Parish Bulletin



6th September 2026

Twenty-Third Sunday In Ordinary Times

Sunday Cycle A, Weekday Cycle 2 Psalter

Week 3

Parish Contact Options

CALL 02895 904304 To connect
and choose the option for the assistance you
require

PARISH OFFICE Option 1

IN THE CASE OF A SICK CALL Option 2

FUNERAL ARRANGEMENTS Option 3

MASS TIMES AND INFORMATION Option 4

FOR FATHER CIARAN FEENEY Option 5

The Parish Office will be open Monday – Thursday

9.30am–12.00pm

In the event of an emergency please call the

Vicariate Mobile on 07549209775

Webcam: [Churchmedia.tv](https://www.churchmedia.tv) or

saintmichaelthearchangel.godaddysites.com

Facebook [Saint Michael the Archangel Parish](#)

Twitter/X [@St-MichaelArch](#)

Email: stmichaels@downandconnor.org



We pray for all our deceased relatives and
friends and for those whose
anniversaries occur at this time.

Anniversaries: Agnes Wasson, Gerry McCann,
Kathleen Hill, Stephen Reynolds, Hugh
McConville, Catherine & Thomas Doyle, Gerald
& Bernard Rafferty, John & Ellen McAlinden,
Bernard McNamee, Charlie O'Donnell.

Months Mind: Joe Hunter

Recently Deceased: Jacqueline Madden

You can book an anniversary Mass or give an
anniversary intention for this section of the
bulletin by calling or e-mailing the parish office
02895 904304 (Option 1)

Email: stmichaels@downandconnor.org



When we look at the Cross, we know how
much Jesus loved us.

When we look at the tabernacle, we know how
much Jesus loves us now.

_ St. Teresa of Calcutta

Sacred Host, greatest aid to holiness, have
mercy on us!



St Michael the Archangel Parish Golden Jubilee Celebrations

To celebrate the 50th Anniversary of St Michael the Archangel Parish, we invite our parishioners and parish family to save the following dates as we look forward to 5 days of Jubilee events this September.

Jubilee Masses

Saturday 26th September at 5.00pm

Sunday 27th September at 11.00am

These special Jubilee Masses will be followed by refreshments in the Parish Hall.

Jubilee Parish Mission

Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday 28th & 30th September at 7.00pm, with Mass each evening. We are delighted to welcome Michelle Moran as our Jubilee Mission speaker.

Michelle Moran is an internationally renowned Catholic speaker, evangelist and co-founder of the Sion Community.

Michelle will also share with our school pupils and staff over those 3 days encouraging them in their faith journey.

Further events will take place throughout our Jubilee Year, including a pilgrimage to St Patrick's Country in Downpatrick next year.

Details of these and other celebrations will be announced in due course.

Please keep these dates free and join us as we give thanks for 50 years of parish life and look forward with hope to the future!



The Offertory Collection for the 30th August amounted to £2514.45

Thank you

TO MAKE A DONATION TO THE PARISH PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE

stmichaelsbelfast.co.uk and click on the **DONATE BUTTON**

Thank you for your continuous support and Generosity

Parish Draw 2026/27 News



Promoter packs are available for collection from the Committee Room beside the Sacristy. Please contact Catherine if you have any queries.

Thank you for your continued support.



This week the sanctuary lamp burns this week in loving memory of Mary & Tommy McGrath

THE WEST BELFAST HISTORICAL SOCIETY

The September meeting will take place on Friday the 11th of September at 7.30pm in St.

Michael's Parish Centre.

The September talk is entitled:

"The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918"

The guest speaker will be Mr Michael McConway
Refreshments will be provided.

(This Talk will be preceded at 7pm with the Annual General Meeting of the Society. It is important that all members of the society are in attendance for this important meeting)

Beginning Experience

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential.

To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

MATT TALBOT – URBAN MYSTIC

The Knights of St Columbanus, CK12

Downpatrick, invite you to a special screening of
Matt Talbot – Urban Mystic at Newcastle
Community Cinema, St Mary's Hall, Main Street,
Newcastle, on Friday 4th September at 7.00pm.

Matt Talbot's remarkable true story of faith,
struggle, addiction and redemption continues to
inspire people throughout the world and offers a
powerful message of hope to those affected by
addiction and their families.

The evening will also feature **guest speaker**

Michael Murphy.

Admission is free, with a suggested donation of
£3 towards costs. Tea and coffee will be served
following the screening.

Everyone is very welcome – please bring family
and friends.

St Joseph Men's Camino

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't
expect, every man needs one. Join men from
across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for
a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley,
beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass,
Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch
and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark
Quinn.

Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student €
55). Registration, accommodation and details:

www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries:
op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Catholic Men's Retreat – Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at

Portglenone Monastery on **Saturday 19**

September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.

The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who
live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians
2:20).

The morning will include prayer, teaching,
fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie
McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey
on 07967 620435 or email

sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

**Congratulations to all our winners this
month!**



Parish Draw for July 2026

1st Prize £500.00 Patrick McArdle

2nd Prize £100.00 Cliodhna Rooney

3rd Prize £100.00 Frances McMahon

4th Prize £100.00 Hugh McConville

5th Prize £100.00 Margaret Hollywood

Promoters Prize £50.00 Anne Duffy

Thank you to all who contribute to the
parish draw.



August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg
*A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life
of faith, for it removes us from our daily
routines, and gives us time and space to
encounter God more deeply.*

Pope Leo XIV

**One Day Retreats – Guided Days of Prayer and
Reflection – places available on**

Sept. 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th & 20th

Admission €50. Group discounts available.

Advance Booking Essential .

Includes Special Themed Retreats:

23rd August – St Peregrine

5th September – Pioneer Pilgrimage

6th September – St Carlos Acutis

9th & 12th September – Vocations Monstrance

19th September – Divine Mercy Pilgrimage

Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage – In the

footsteps of pilgrims through the centuries

Sunday 30th August. 8km & 12km routes, fully

guided. Outdoor Mass weather permitting.

Admission €25. Advance Booking Essential.

NEW FOR 2026 SEASON –Overnight

**accommodation available on Station Island the
night before beginning a Retreat or Pilgrimage.**

Lough Derg, Pettigo, Co Donegal. F94 PC60

www.loughderg.org email. info@loughderg.org Tel.

0719861518

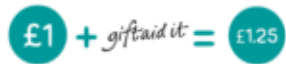
*Abide in His Love Women's Conference. The
Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20-22
November 2026.*

Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more.

A conference not to be missed!

Register

now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>



Making your donations go further with no extra cost to you!

Did you know you can GIFT AID your collections to the Parish? Donating through Gift Aid means we can claim an extra 25p for every £1 you give. It will not cost you any extra. If you pay tax, even a tiny amount on a small pension, we can claim an extra 25p in each £1 you donate to St Michael's Parish. Interested in hearing more? Call in or give us a call.

If you already contribute through the envelope system or by standing order and are a tax payer who would like to gift aid your donations please complete one of the gift aid declarations and return to the office.

**Sunday 6th September 2026**

We pray for the happy repose of the
souls of:

Recently deceased:

Brendan Morris, Paddy Elliot, Patricia McFarlane

Anniversaries/Intentions:

Ann Rice, Gerard Hughes, Benny McKinley,
Owen & Tom Monaghan



Sunday Mass 11am
Saturday Vigil Mass 6.30pm
Mon, Tues, Wed at 10am



Friday at 7.30pm except the first Friday of the month when we
have the Mass with the Blessing of the Sick at 7pm.

Confession is 5.45pm - 6.15pm on a Saturday

6pm - 7pm on a Wednesday.

Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November. The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating.

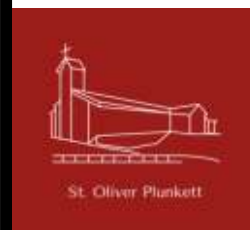
Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in

St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays

(26th September 24th October and 21st November)

Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669

or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

**St Oliver Plunkett Parish**

27b Glenveagh Drive, Belfast,
BT11 9HX. T: 028 9061 8180

Fr. Tony McAleese

(Office hours 9am - 1pm Mon, Tues, Thurs & Fri)

E: stoliverplunkett@downandconnor.org

www.stoliverplunkettparish.ie

Webcam: stoliverplunkettparish.ie/live-mass

SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER 2026

**Black Mountain Family of Parishes**

Our emergency phone 07549209775.

**Only for those needing the last rites, or in
the case of a death. Thank you.**



Fr McCullagh	St Agnes	028 90615 702
Fr Gabriel Lyons	St Teresa's	028 9061 2855
Fr Ciaran Feeney	St Michaels	028 9508 8030
Fr Brendan Mulhall	Holy Trinity	028 9059 0985
Fr Patrick Devlin	St Joseph's	028 9061 4567

***Fr Colin Grant and Fr Joe McGuigan are both assisting
in our family of parishes***

Remember.....

Book your month mind and anniversary Masses early as we only take so many for each mass. We don't like to disappoint. A month mind mass must be booked by the family of the deceased.

Thanks.



Parish Income Update



If you wish to set up a direct debit in place of using your envelopes, call into the office.

Weekly Income Sunday 30th August: £869.64

Thank you to all our parishioners for your generosity and continued loyalty to St Oliver Plunkett parish.



Please note the office is closed on Monday 7th September. We will reopen on Tuesday 8th September at 9am. **Thank you.**



Mass for the New School Year

This Mass will take place on Wednesday 9th September at 10am.

All welcome.

The Carson Academy of Irish Dance welcomes new beginners to our classes at **Carson Studios, Tullyglass Business Park, Springbank Industrial Estate.**

Beginners – Girls & Boys Age 4+ on Wednesdays 6–7pm | Thursdays 5–6pm

Junior Jiggers – Age 2–4 on Saturdays 11–11:45am

Classes commence **week of 7th September. Enquiries/Booking:**

WhatsApp: 07429 496240 or Email: carson_acd@icloud.com

Catholic Men's Retreat - Standing in the Breach

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at **Portglenone Monastery** on **Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm.**

The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker.

All men are very welcome.

For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG

Saturday 19th September

Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm .

The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs

A Year of Ignatian Prayer 2026-2027 – Belfast Jesuit Centre

There are a few places remaining on our immersive programme in Ignatian Spirituality, which returns on Saturday 26th September; offering ten in-person Saturdays (10am–4pm) in the BJC and seven online Integrative Practice Pause Points to support prayer, discernment and reflective living. Open to those new to Ignatian Spirituality and those seeking to deepen their practice. Suggested donation: £200–£280. Bursaries available.

For dates and registration, please visit: <https://belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk/a-year-of-ignatian-prayer-2026-2027/>

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of The Chosen: Season 2 will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at 10.45am, episode at 11.00am, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion.

All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct.

Contact: bjc@jesuit.ie | 07955 282371 | belfastjesuitcentre.co.uk

Vacancy with Down & Connor - Pastoral Ministry Co-ordinator

Following a review of this Fixed Term Contract, we are re-advertising the role of Pastoral Ministry Co-Ordinator, which will be based at the Jesuit Centre Belfast and will work alongside the Chaplain to the University of Ulster, Belfast Campus.

We are posting the vacancy on the Diocese of Down and Connor website, nijobs.com and the Community NI website, as well as other outlets, with the application pack available from the Diocesan website at Diocese of Down and Connor under the tab /Job Vacancies. The job ad closes at 12 noon on Thursday 10 September 2026.



Parish of Downpatrick

Sunday 06 September 2026

23rd, Sunday in Ordinary Time



PRIESTS: Fr Eugene O'Neill PP, Fr. Jim Conway CC

Contacts:

Parish Office: 07337 485743 (TEMPORARY PARISH OFFICE NUMBER)

For emergencies please ring (for example- an urgent sick call or a sudden death): 07841101678

Temporary Address until further notice: Patrician Youth Centre, John Street, BT30 6HS

**New Office hours 10.00am – 2.00pm Monday & Thursday
New office hours 10.00am – 1.00pm Tuesday & Wednesday**

Parish Support Officer: Tel: 07337 485743

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since Downpatrick is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: downpatrick@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricksdowndpatrick.com

 [downpatrickfamilyofparishes](https://www.facebook.com/downpatrickfamilyofparishes)

Mass Schedule:

Downpatrick Parish Mass Schedule:

Weekend Masses

Vigils

St. Patrick's 5pm

St Brigid's 6.30pm

Sunday

St Patrick's 10.30am

St. Malachy's – 1st Sunday of the Month – 9am –

Daily Masses

Monday 7.30pm **St. Patrick's**

Tues – Friday 10am **St. Patrick's**

St. Colmcille's

Wednesday 7:30pm

Sacrament of Baptism: 2nd, 3rd & 4th Sunday of each month

Confession available in St Patrick's, Saturdays 4.15pm – 4.45pm

PARISH COLLECTIONS:

30 August 2026

Offertory £2169 **Medical Missionaries** £1370

To donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are: **Account Name: Parish of Downpatrick, Account Number: 80146471, Sort Code: 95-06-79** (please add an identifying name to your transaction) please contact your bank to arrange.

Dona Card Machine is available for convenience at Our Lady's Shrine.

Thank You for your ongoing support.

NAME CHANGE

You will have noticed that the new title “PARISH SUPPORT OFFICER” is being used in the bulletin information section and in the job advertisements in this weeks parish bulletin. This is simply the new term for parish secretary being used across the diocese.

MASS INTENTIONS:

Saturday 05 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:

Anniv: Dominic Mcilmail, Hubert Doyle,

Monday 07 September, St. Patrick's, 7:30pm:

Anniv: Mary Ritchie,

Wednesday 09 September, St. Colmcille's, 7:30pm:

Anniv: Michael Molloy,

Saturday 12 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:

Month's Mind: Anthony Sturgess,

1st Anniv: Maudie Marks, John McCormick

Anniv: Mark McKee, Jackie Walsh, Josephine Torney,

Saturday 12 September, St. Brigid's, 6:30pm:

Month's Mind: Michael Miller,

Sunday 13 September, St. Patrick's, 10:30am:

Month's Mind: Dermot MacNabb,

Anniv: Rosaleen MacNabb,

If you would like a Mass booking, please drop into the sacristy and make the booking directly with the priest.

Your Prayers are Requested for:

Recently Deceased: Frank Boyd, Oliver Cunningham, Patrick Kearney, Joseph McEvoy,

Anniv: Andrew Diamond, James Breen, Dominic Mcilmail,

Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:- Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am, Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am. To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723

Lectio Divina will resume on Tuesday 8th September at 11 o'clock (please note the correct day). We will be using the small room in the church that is used on Sundays for children's liturgy. Lectio Divina is the practice of reading scripture, meditation and prayer. New members are very welcome.

RCIA 2026 / 2027: Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September and runs weekly from 6.30 to 8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are also very welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To find out more, scan the QR code or visit our information page, or email rcia@downandconnor.org to register.



Scouts will hold a registration evening on Monday 7th September for Beavers from 7 to 8 pm. Tuesday 8th September for Cubs from 7 to 8.30. Any queries contact the scout hall on 02844839841.

DAY RETREAT TO LOUGH DERG: Saturday 19th September Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am Returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. The day Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price for Retreat is £45 plus the bus price determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Mon - Thurs..

Assist us to live, not to die...

The Bill to allow assisted dying is being brought before the WESTMINSTER PARLIAMENT on 11 September. The consequences for the sick, vulnerable and old are terrible to contemplate. Please take a card explaining the dangers and consider sending to your MP.

Safeguarding: If you have a concern, suspicion, or wish to make an allegation of child abuse, or abuse in relation to an adult at risk, please contact the Diocesan Safeguarding Office: Philip O'Hara, Designated Liaison Person, 120, Cliftonville Road, Belfast BT14 6LA. Mobile: 07534 992124 or Telephone: 028 90 492798. Email: philip.ohara@soddc.org or visit <https://downandconnorsafeguarding.com>